AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Sentinel Ops

Blue Team, SOC & DFIR Tools

47	224,191	98%	42
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Intro: Detect, hunt, forensicate — the defensive operations toolkit.

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-17 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects and note who uses each tool and the commercial product it replaces; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — **444 curated free tools across 14 realms**.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
CC0 · 2026-10-17

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-17

47	46	224,191	42	3,436	2011
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Intro: Detect, hunt, forensicate — the defensive operations toolkit.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

The Sentinel Ops blue team, SOC, and DFIR tool realm includes 47 curated tools, 46 hosted on GitHub, with 98% of the collection available via the platform. 42 of these tools received code pushes in 2026, indicating active maintenance for most of the library, while four quiet classics—sysmon-config, Revoke-Obfuscation, DeepBlueCLI, and HELK—have not seen recent updates. Adoption is heavily concentrated in top-starred tools, with osquery leading at 23.7k stars, followed by Wazuh (17.3k) and Atomic Red Team (12.7k), which together account for a large share of the combined 224,191 total stars across the realm. Python is the most common language, used in 12 tools, followed by Go and C each at 7, and the median tool has 3,436 stars, showing a mix of high-impact popular tools and smaller niche offerings. The oldest entry dates to October 12, 2011, providing a long-running foundation for the blue team tooling ecosystem, with a license mix weighted toward other/none (19 tools) followed by GPL (12) and MIT (8).

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

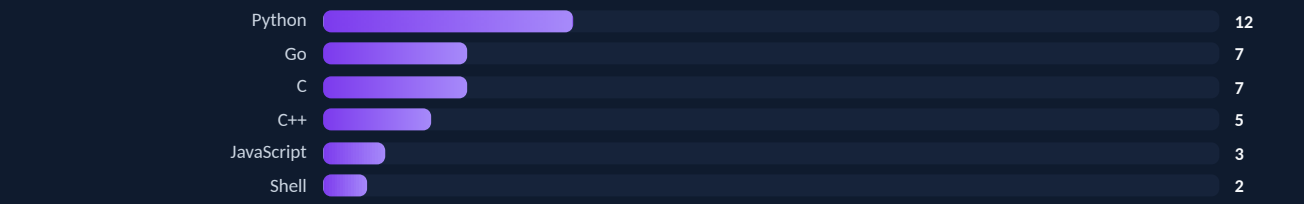
TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



LANGUAGE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES

The Sleuth Kit	2011-10-12
Zeek	2012-07-06
Arkime	2012-07-06
Suricata	2012-08-14
YARA	2012-12-06

THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS

Krawl	2025-12
RITA	2024-06
Sublime Platform	2021-04
Sublime Rules	2021-02
Sysmon for Linux	2020-10

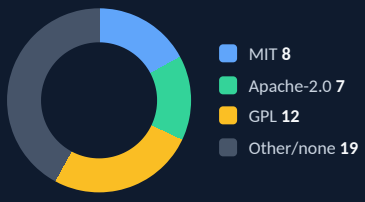
CREATION ERAS — WHEN THE REALM WAS BUILT

2008-2012	2013-2016	2017-2020	2021-2026
5	17	20	4

QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

sysmon-config, Revoke-Obfuscation, DeepBlueCLI, HELK

LICENSE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, **who uses it and which commercial product it replaces**, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

Profiles are ordered by GitHub adoption (stars). Non-GitHub entries follow, alphabetically. Flagship marks the realm's top 8 by stars.

01 osquery

github.com/osquery/osquery

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 23.7k	GITHUB STARS
2,619	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"SQL powered operating system instrumentation, monitoring, and analytics."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

operate endpoints as a SQL database: ask security questions, get rows back.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by IT-security teams querying endpoints with SQL; the open-source foundation Facebook built for fleet visibility.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



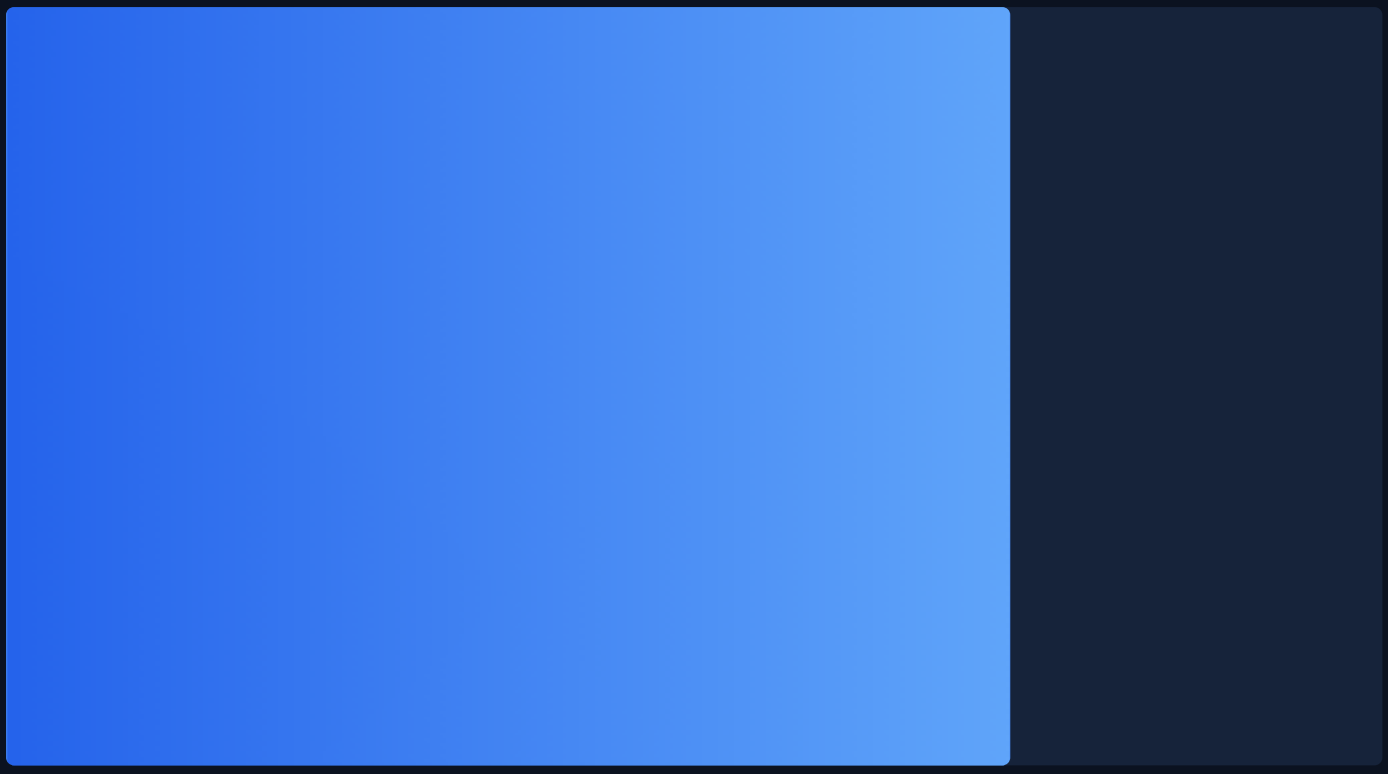
12	2,619	583	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

02 Wazuh

github.com/wazuh/wazuh

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 17.3k	GITHUB STARS
2,545	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Wazuh - The Open Source Security Platform. Unified XDR and SIEM protection for endpoints and cloud workloads."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open-source XDR/SIEM: FIM, log analysis, vulnerability detection and compliance reporting in one free platform.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by SOC teams running open XDR and SIEM; the free alternative to Splunk, QRadar and commercial EDR stacks.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



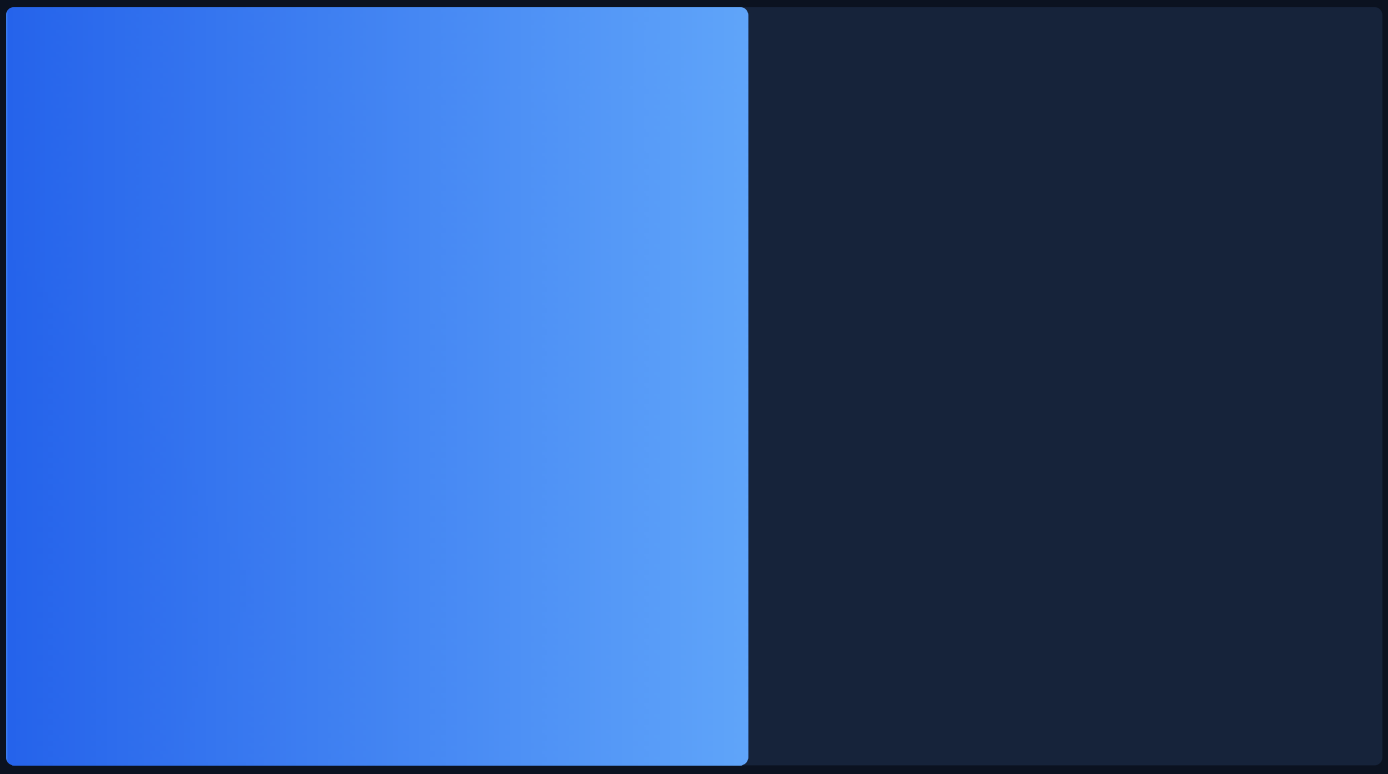
11	2,545	3,128	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

03 Atomic Red Team

github.com/redcanaryco/atomic-red-team

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 12.7k	GITHUB STARS
3,236	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Small and highly portable detection tests based on MITRE's ATT&CK."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

library of executable detection tests mapped to MITRE ATT&CK; prove your defenses fire.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by purple teams testing detections per ATT&CK technique; the open-source alternative to commercial breach-attack-simulation platforms.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



9	3,236	36	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

04 Sigma

github.com/SigmaHQ/sigma

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 11.3k	GITHUB STARS
2,865	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Main Sigma Rule Repository"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

vendor-neutral SIEM detection rules — "Snort for logs", convertible to Splunk/Sentinel/Elastic.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by detection engineers writing portable detection rules; the vendor-neutral alternative to proprietary SIEM rule languages. (DRL 1.1 rules)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



10	2,865	272	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

05 awesome-honeypots

github.com/paralax/awesome-honeypots

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 10.6k	GITHUB STARS
1,404	FORKS
2026-06	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
Artistic-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"an awesome list of honeypot resources"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the curated honeypot directory: deception tech from low to high interaction.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by deception researchers picking deployable honeypots. (curated list)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



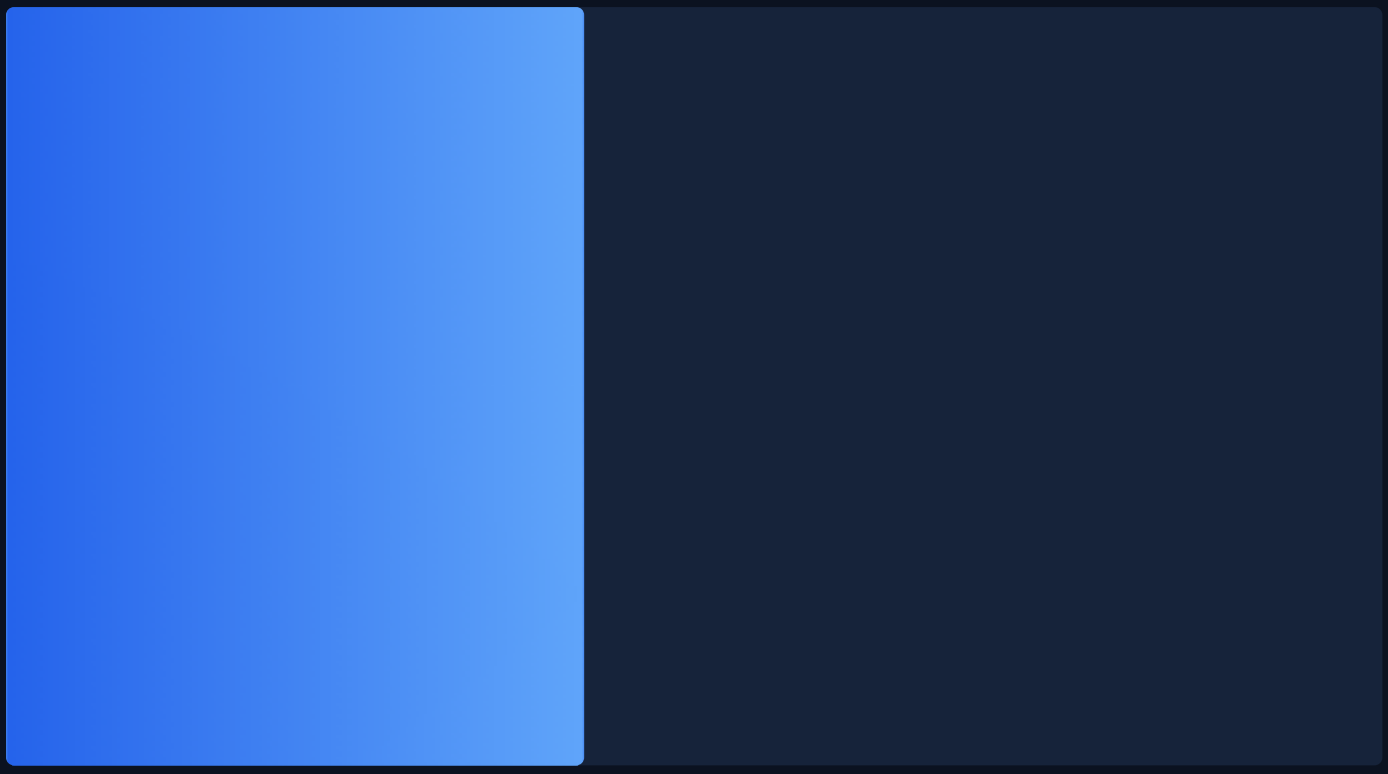
11	1,404	30	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

06 YARA

github.com/VirusTotal/yara

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 10k	GITHUB STARS
1,587	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
BSD-3-Clause	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The pattern matching swiss knife"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the pattern-matching language for malware identification — if you write detections, you write YARA.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by malware analysts everywhere to classify samples; the pattern-matching standard commercial AV also uses.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	1,587	164	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

07 Awesome Incident Response

github.com/meirwah/awesome-incident-response

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 9.5k	GITHUB STARS
1,763	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
—	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A curated list of tools for incident response"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the curated IR toolkit index used across the industry.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by DFIR professionals assembling their toolkit.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11	1,763	92	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

08 ntopng

github.com/ntop/ntopng

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 8.3k	GITHUB STARS
773	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Lua	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Web-based Traffic and Cybersecurity Network Traffic Monitoring"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

high-speed web-based traffic monitoring: flows, top talkers and protocols with long historical views.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by network engineers observing traffic in real time; the open-source traffic-analysis alternative to commercial NPM tools.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11	773	323	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

09 Zeek

github.com/zeek/zeek

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 8.1k	GITHUB STARS
1,438	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Zeek is a powerful network analysis framework that is much different from the typical IDS you may know."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the network analysis framework that turns raw traffic into structured, queryable intelligence.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by NSM teams producing rich network telemetry; the framework most SOC pipelines are built around.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	1,438	263	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

10 Arkime

github.com/arkime/arkime

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 7.5k	GITHUB STARS
1,171	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Arkime is an open source, large scale, full packet capturing, indexing, and database system."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

full-packet capture plus indexed search at scale (formerly Moloch); PCAP you can actually query.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by NSM teams capturing and searching full packets at scale; the open-source alternative to commercial full-packet-capture appliances.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	1,171	42	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

11 Suricata

github.com/OISF/suricata

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.7k	GITHUB STARS
1,779	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Suricata is a network Intrusion Detection System, Intrusion Prevention System and Network Security Monitoring engine developed by the OISF and the Suricata community."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

high-performance IDS/IPS/NSM engine with full protocol logging and Eve JSON output.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by network defenders running IDS/IPS at line rate; the open-source engine behind countless commercial and gov deployments.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



14	1,779	104	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

12 capa

github.com/mandiant/capa

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.2k	GITHUB STARS
735	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The FLARE team's open-source tool to identify capabilities in executable files."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

identifies what malware actually does: maps capabilities and ATT&CK techniques straight from binaries.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by malware analysts determining what binaries can do; the open-source capability engine from Mandiant research.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



6	735	305	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

13 pspy

github.com/DominicBreuker/pspy

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.2k	GITHUB STARS
574	FORKS
2026-03	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Monitor linux processes without root permissions"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

watch process and file events on any Linux box without root — catch cron-based persistence in the act.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentesters and CTF players watching process activity without root; the standard privesc enumeration tool.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



8	574	3	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

14 sysmon-config

github.com/SwiftOnSecurity/sysmon-config

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.7k	GITHUB STARS
1,866	FORKS
2024-07	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
None	LICENSE
—	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Sysmon configuration file template with default high-quality event tracing"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the battle-tested Sysmon configuration behind thousands of SOC detections; the de-facto starting point for Windows telemetry.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by blue teams deploying hardened Windows logging; the widely-adopted SwiftOnSecurity baseline.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



9	1,866	83	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

15 ThreatMapper

github.com/deepfence/ThreatMapper

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.3k	GITHUB STARS
632	FORKS
2026-06	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
TypeScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Open Source Cloud Native Application Protection Platform (CNAPP)"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Deepfence's open runtime threat scanner: finds and ranks exploitable vulnerabilities in cloud and container workloads.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by cloud security teams mapping runtime risks; Deepfence's open-source alternative to commercial CNAPPs.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



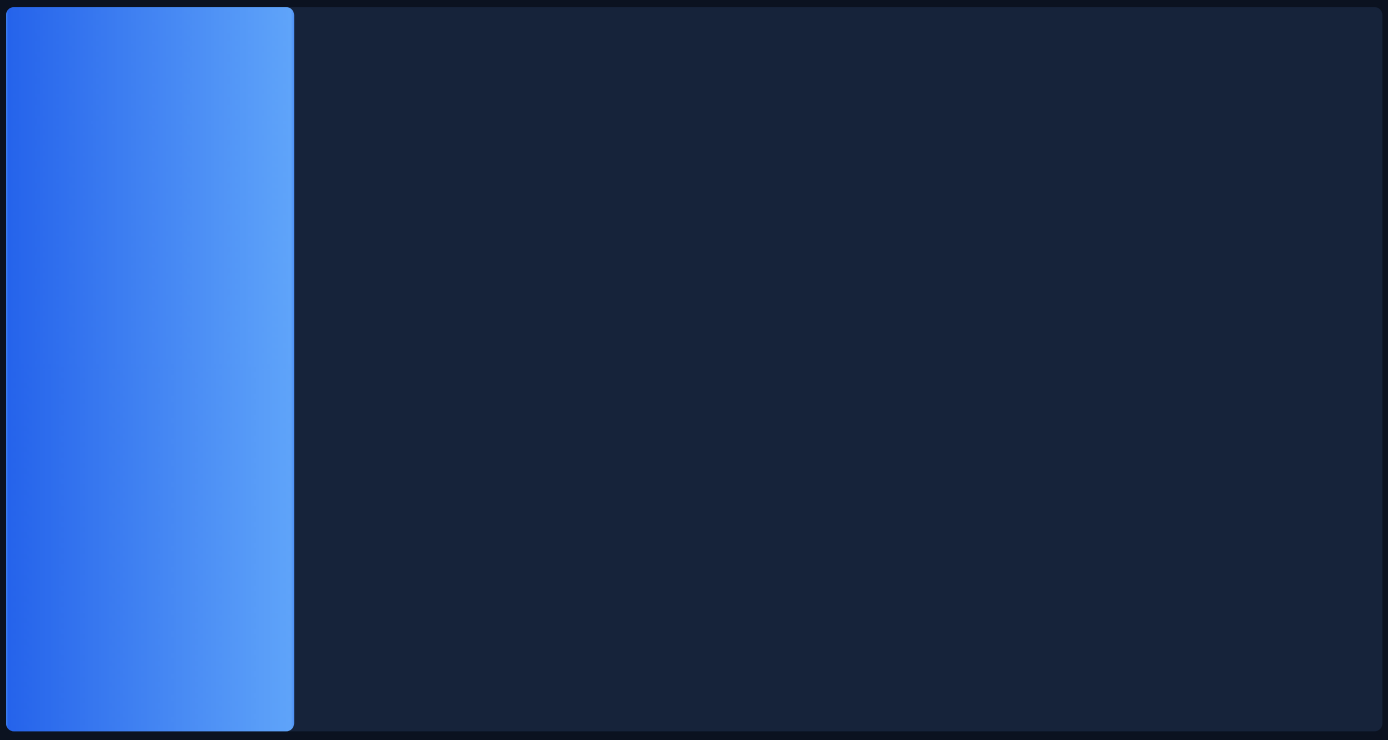
6	632	144	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

16 Security Onion

github.com/Security-Onion-Solutions/securityonion

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.9k	GITHUB STARS
680	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Shell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Security Onion is a free and open platform for threat hunting, enterprise security monitoring, and log management. It includes our own interfaces for alerting, dashboards, hunting, PCAP, detections, and case management."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the free SOC-in-a-box distro: Suricata, Zeek, Elastic, dashboards and detection pipelines.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by SOC and DFIR teams as a complete network-security-monitoring distro; the free alternative to commercial NSM suites.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



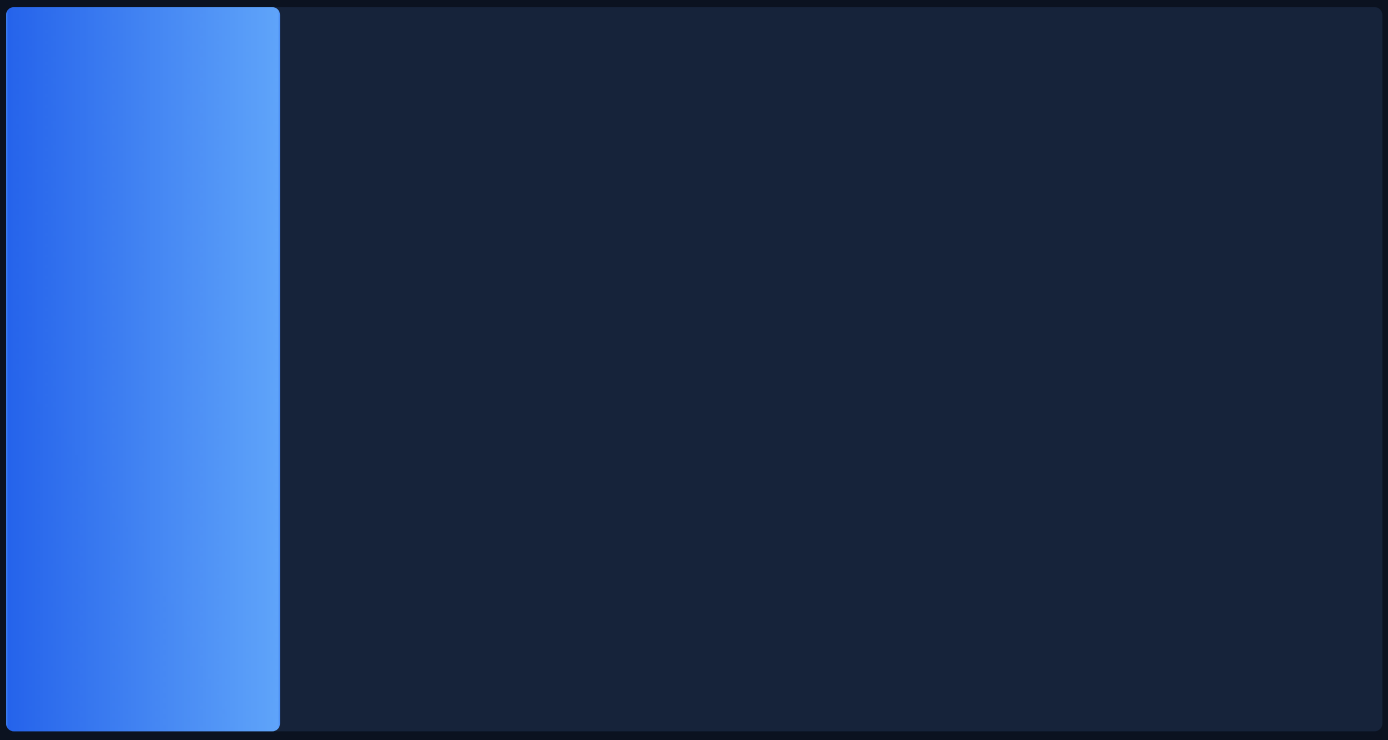
8	680	85	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

17 Threat Hunter Playbook

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/OTRF/ThreatHunter-Playbook

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.7k	GITHUB STARS
867	FORKS
2026-01	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A community-driven, open-source project to share detection logic, adversary tradecraft and resources to make detection development more efficient."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open hunting playbooks as code: hypotheses mapped to data sources and detections.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by threat hunters learning detection strategy; the open knowledge base for hunting methodology.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



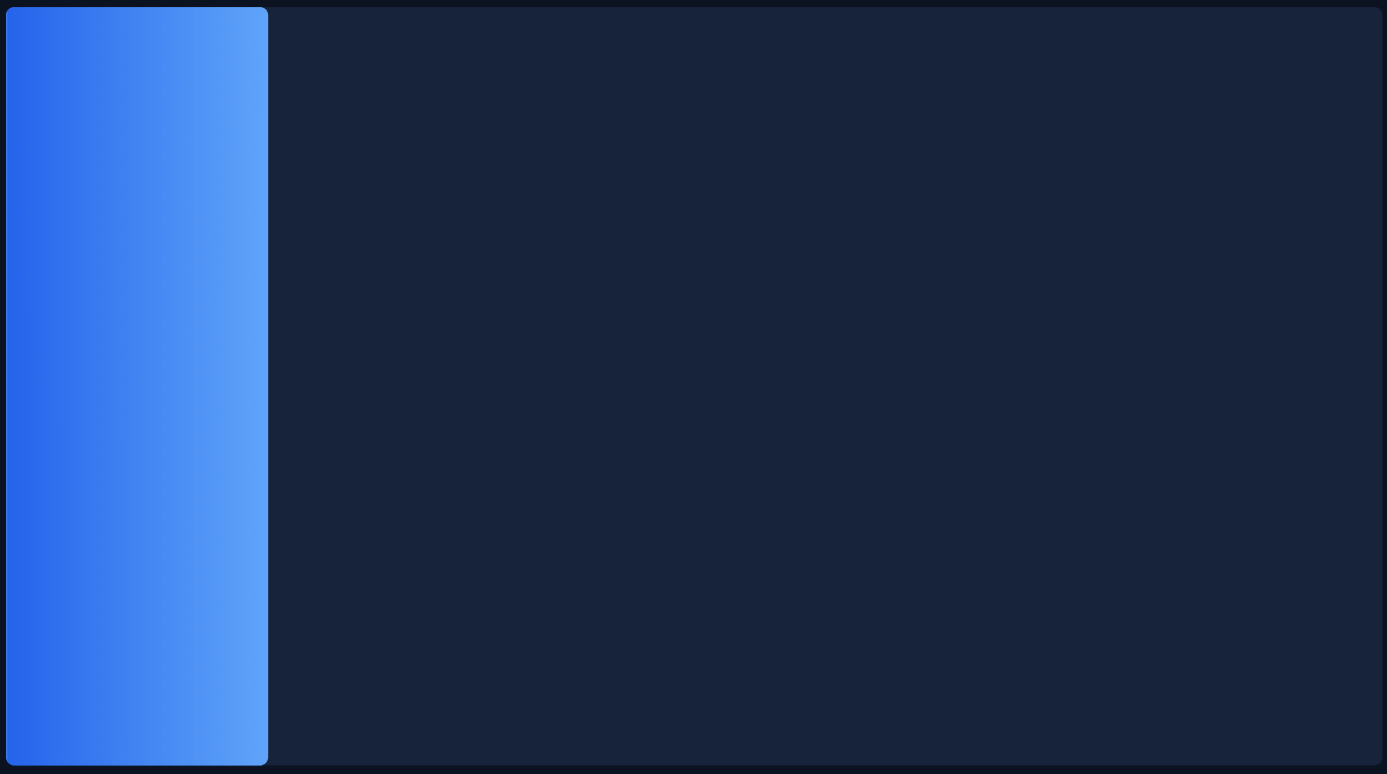
9	867	6	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

18 Volatility 3

github.com/volatilityfoundation/volatility3

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.5k	GITHUB STARS
723	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Volatility 3.0 development"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

memory forensics framework — RAM malware has nowhere to hide.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by DFIR analysts extracting artifacts from memory images; the framework that defined open memory forensics.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



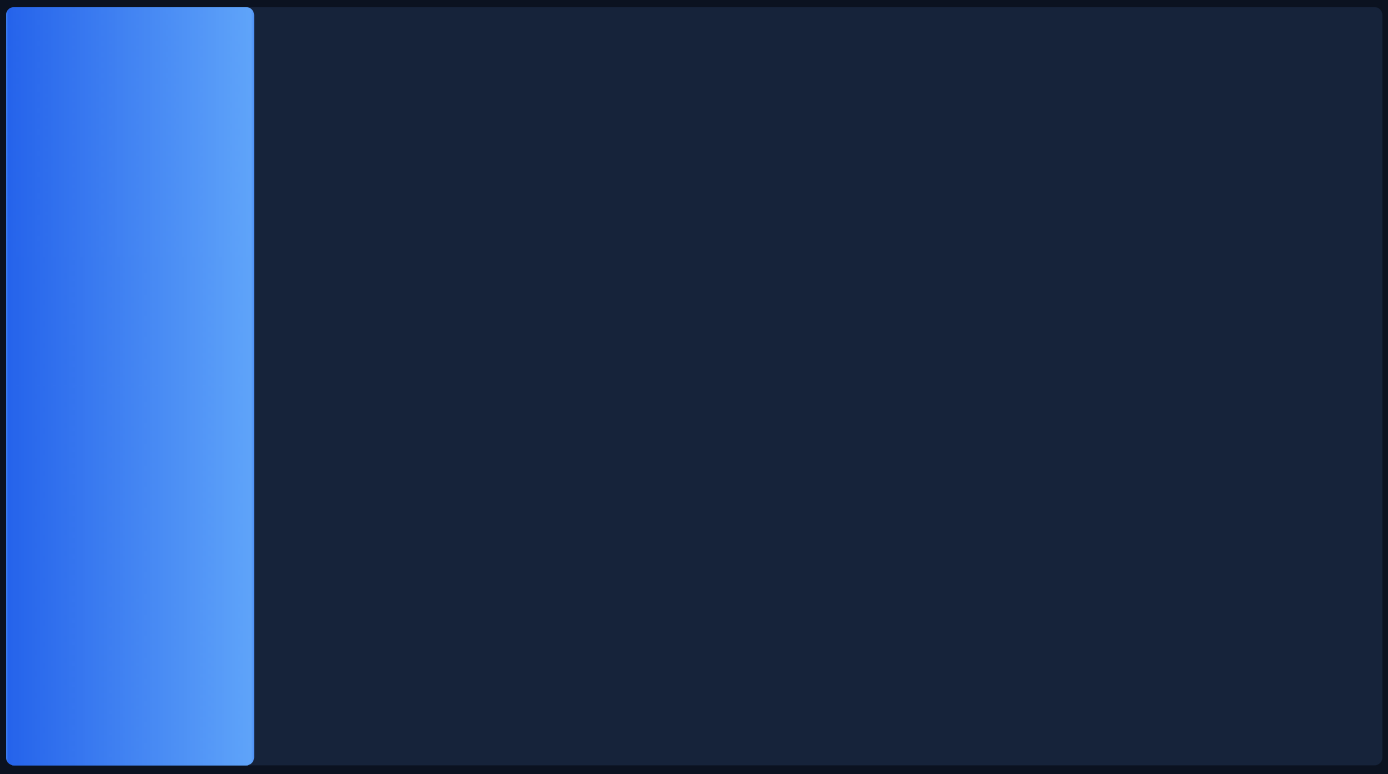
12	723	148	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

19 Velociraptor

github.com/Velocidex/velociraptor

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.3k	GITHUB STARS
670	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Digging Deeper...."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

endpoint visibility and DFIR at scale: hunt across thousands of machines with one query language.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by DFIR teams hunting across thousands of endpoints; the open-source alternative to commercial endpoint-forensics platforms.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



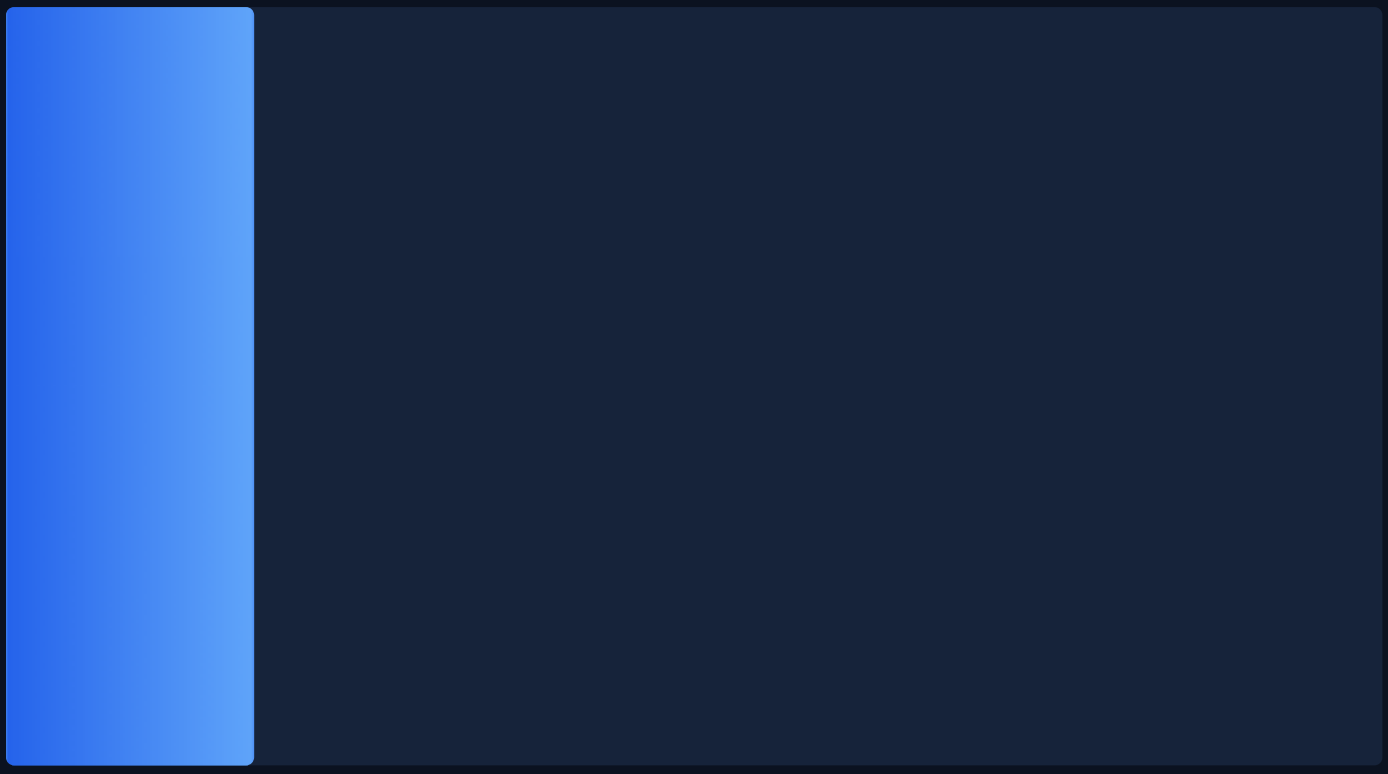
8	670	86	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

20 Awesome YARA

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/InQuest/awesome-yara

star weight vs realm #1



★ 4.3k	GITHUB STARS
558	FORKS
2026-06	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
—	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A curated list of awesome YARA rules, tools, and people."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

curated YARA rules, tooling and research for malware hunting.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by malware analysts collecting detection rules.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

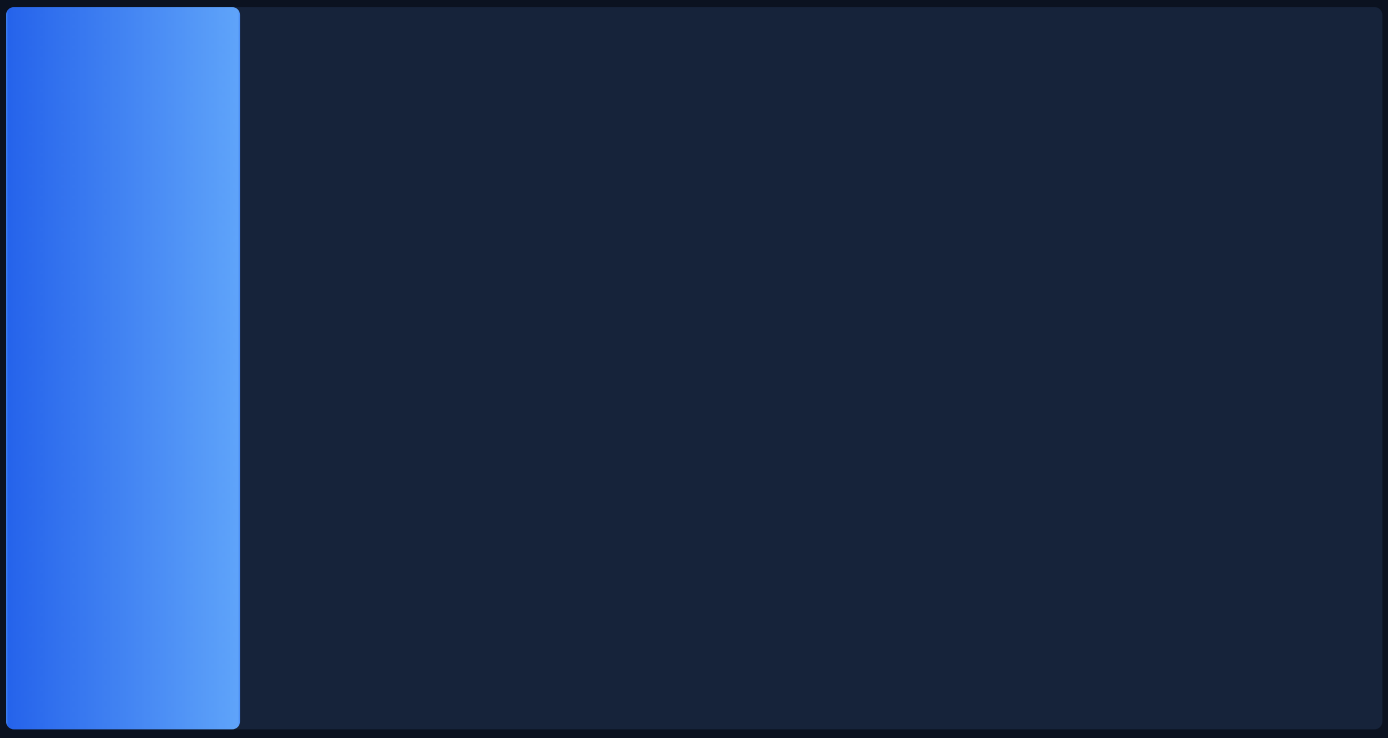


9	558	1	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

21 HELK

github.com/Cyb3rWard0g/HELK

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.9k	GITHUB STARS
691	FORKS
2024-06	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Jupyter Notebook	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The Hunting ELK"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Hunting ELK: a pre-built Elasticsearch/Kafka/Spark lab for threat-hunting research — a research project with low churn.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by threat-hunting learners standing up an ELK hunting lab; the open-source project for detection-engineering practice.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



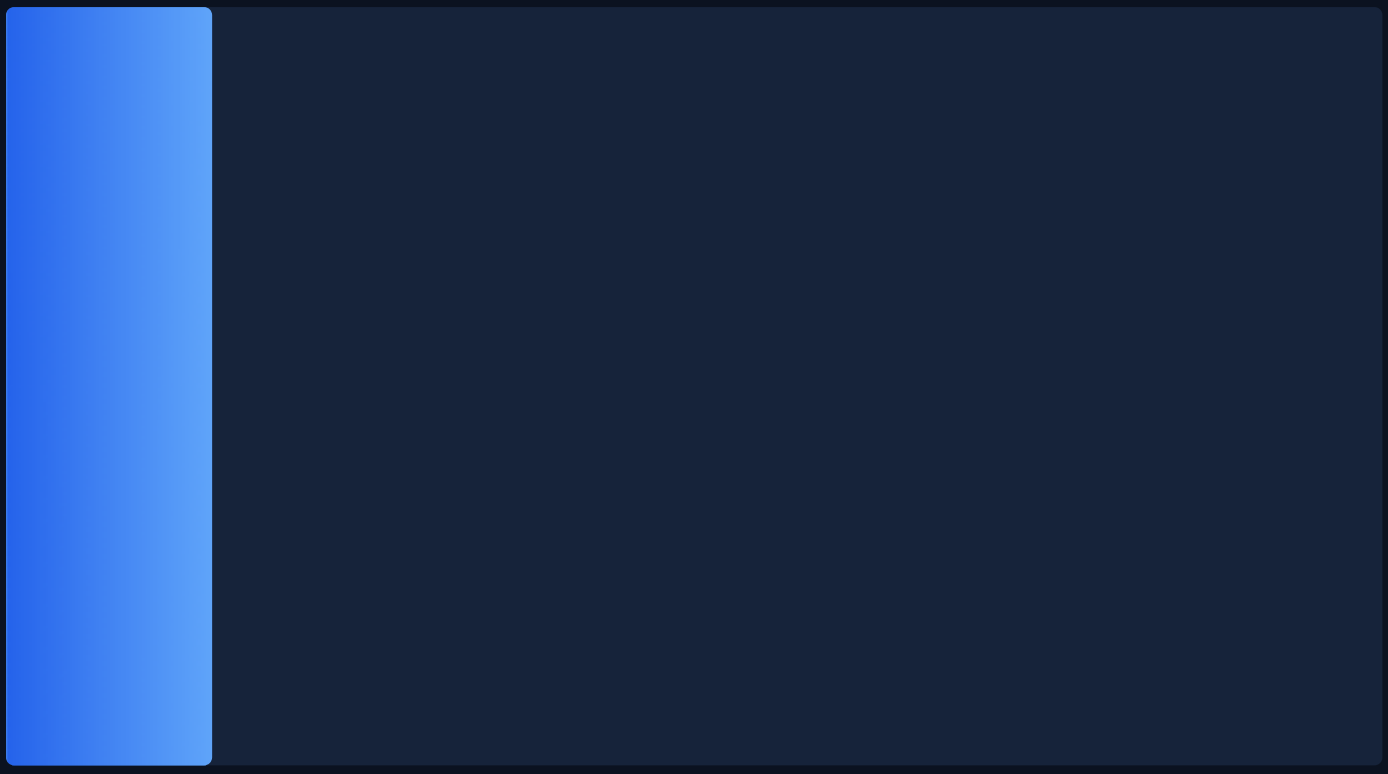
9	691	60	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

22 CAPEv2

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/kevoreilly/CAPEv2

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.6k	GITHUB STARS
614	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Malware Configuration And Payload Extraction"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the maintained Cuckoo sandbox: automated malware detonation, config extraction and reporting.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by malware analysts running automated sandbox detonations; the open-source alternative to commercial sandboxes like JoeSandbox.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



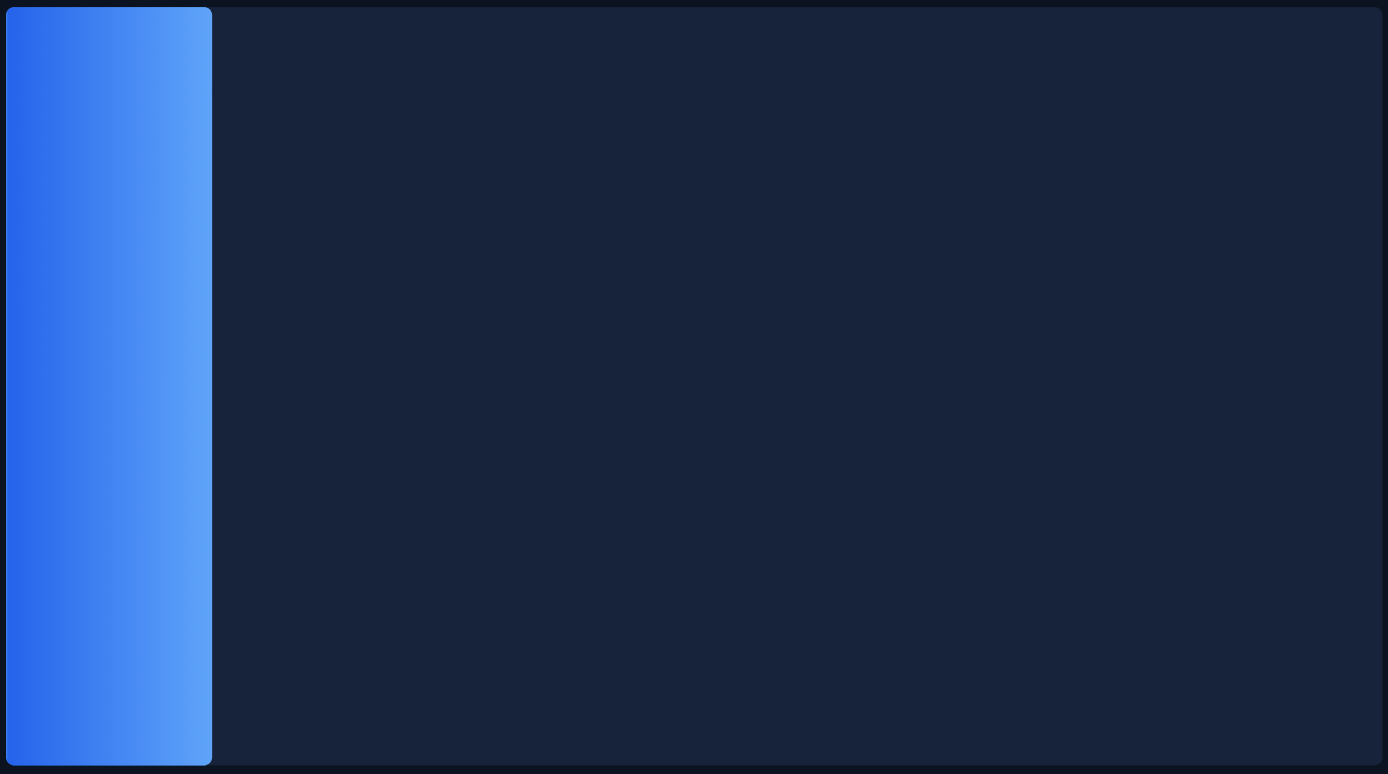
7	614	95	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

23 Snort 3

github.com/snort3/snort3

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.4k	GITHUB STARS
690	FORKS
2026-04	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Snort++”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the next generation of the classic open-source IDS/IPS, rewritten in C++ with multi-threading.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by network defenders running the classic open IDS; the engine that defined open-source intrusion detection.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



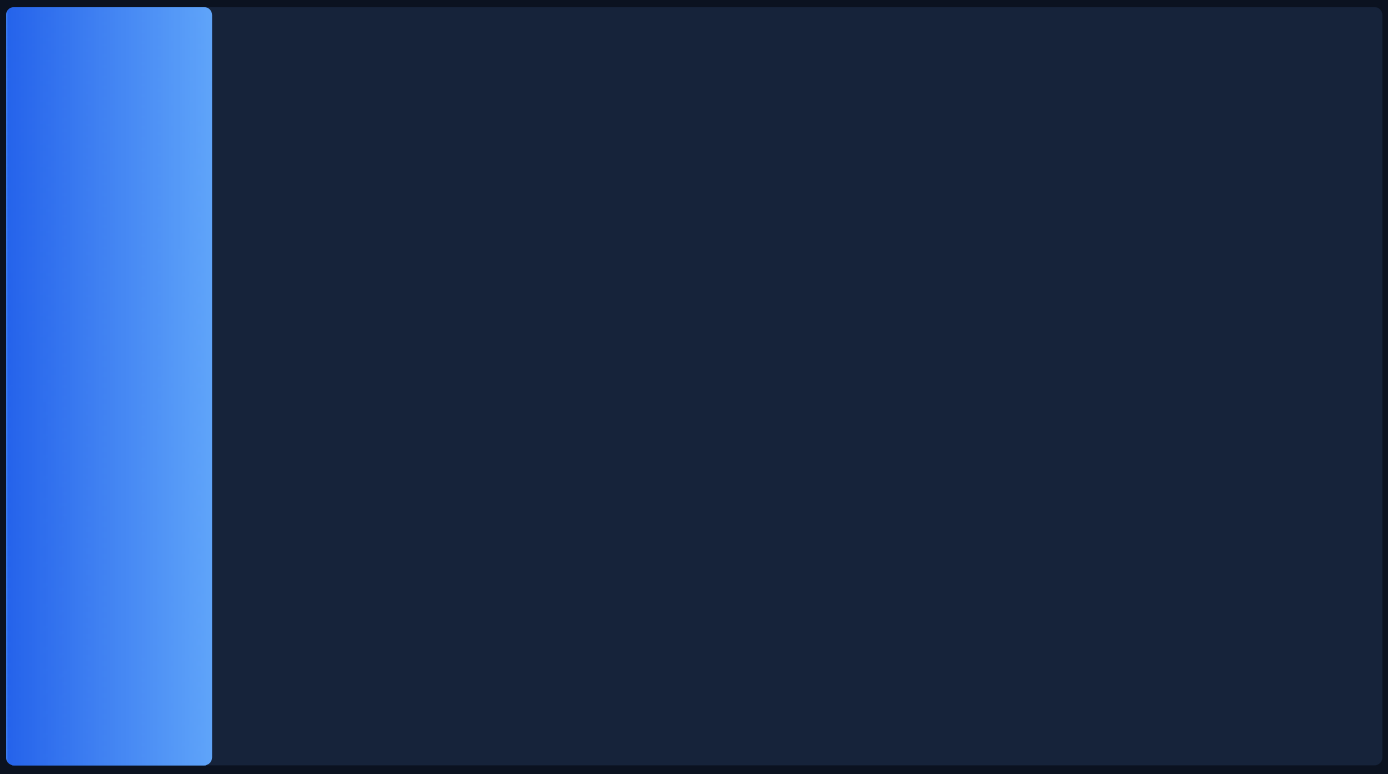
12	690	85	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

24 Timesketch

github.com/google/timesketch

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.4k	GITHUB STARS
671	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Collaborative forensic timeline analysis"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Google's collaborative forensic timeline analysis for multi-investigator cases.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by DFIR analysts building collaborative forensic timelines; the open-source alternative to commercial timeline-analysis tools.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



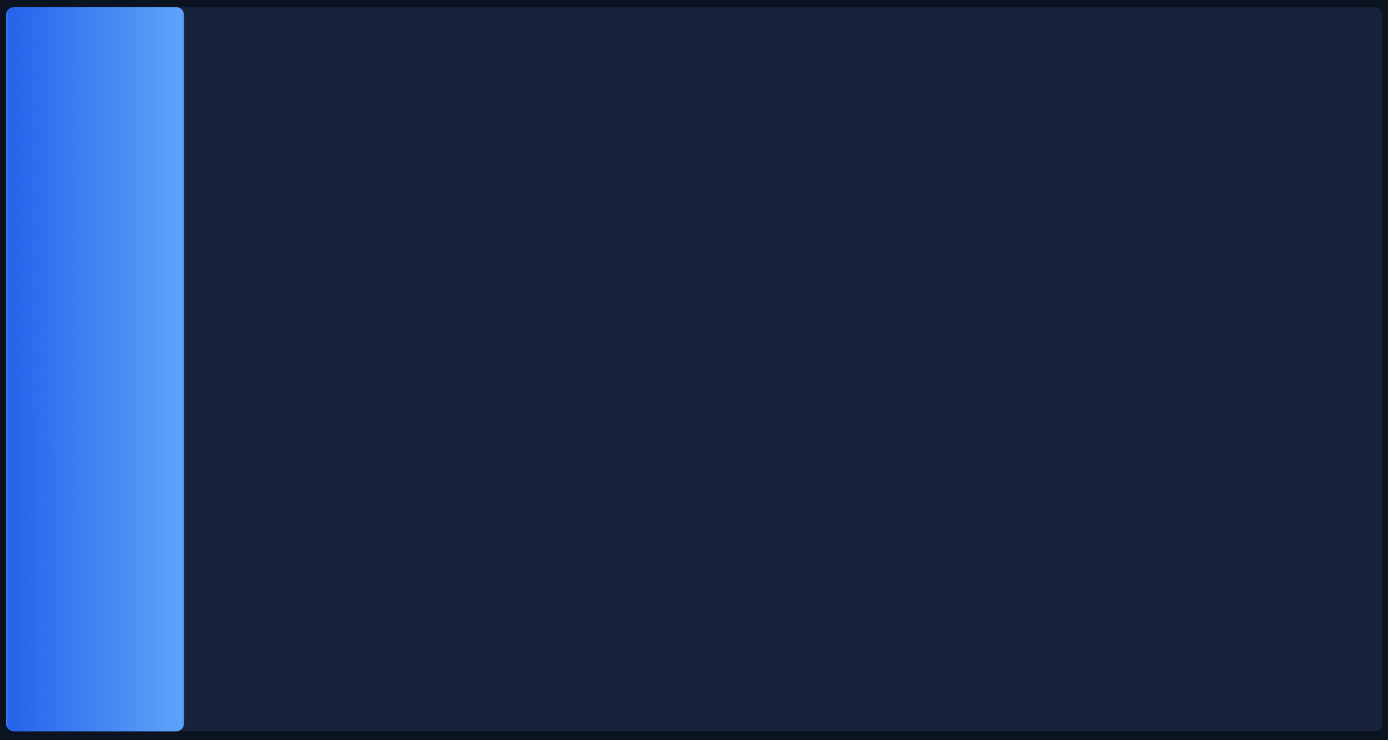
12	671	228	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

25 The Sleuth Kit

github.com/sleuthkit/sleuthkit

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.2k	GITHUB STARS
715	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2011	FIRST DEVELOPED
None	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The Sleuth Kit® (TSK) is a library and collection of command line digital forensics tools that allow you to investigate volume and file system data. The library can be incorporated into larger digital forensics tools and"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the forensic library behind half the DFIR tools you know: disks, filesystems and timelines.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by DFIR analysts examining disk images and file systems; the open-source foundation under commercial forensic suites.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



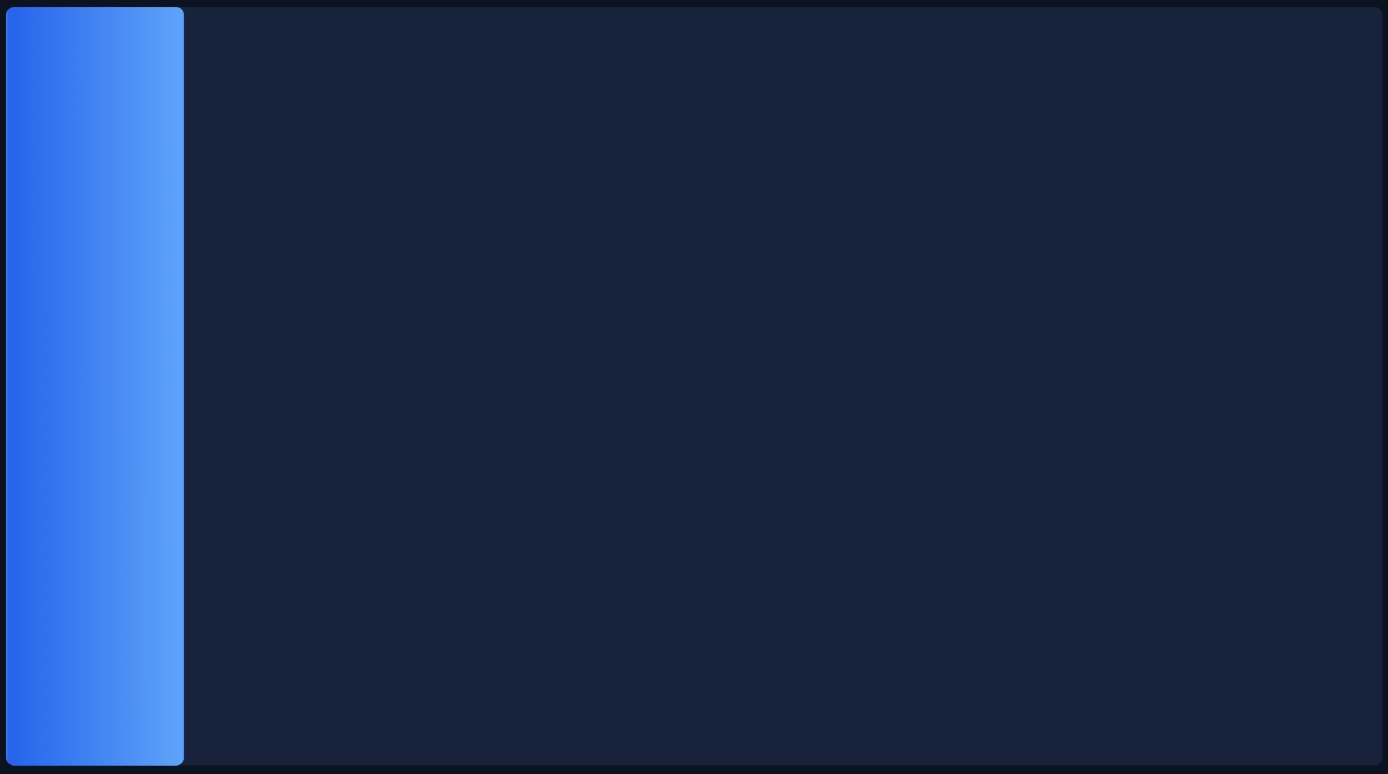
15	715	487	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

26 sysmon-modular

github.com/olafhartong/sysmon-modular

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.2k	GITHUB STARS
661	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A repository of sysmon configuration modules"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Swiss-army Sysmon configuration: per-ATT&CK-technique logging modules you compose yourself.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by detection engineers tailoring Sysmon per event type; the community config alternative to fixed baselines.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



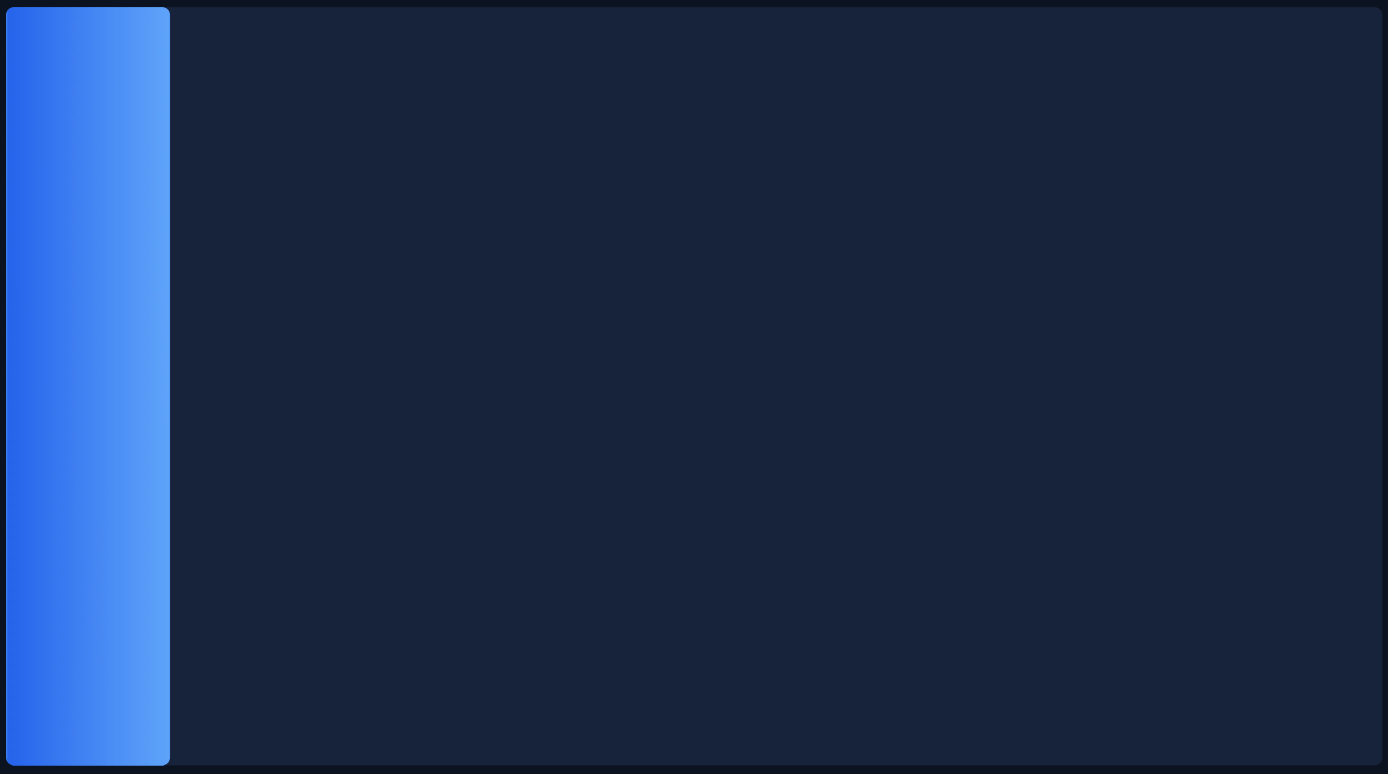
8	661	50	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

27 Elastic detection-rules

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/elastic/detection-rules

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.7k	GITHUB STARS
708	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Elastic detection-rules"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the detection corpus for Elastic Security: hundreds of maintained rules mapped to MITRE.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by SOC teams deploying detection content; the open-source ruleset behind Elastic Security.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



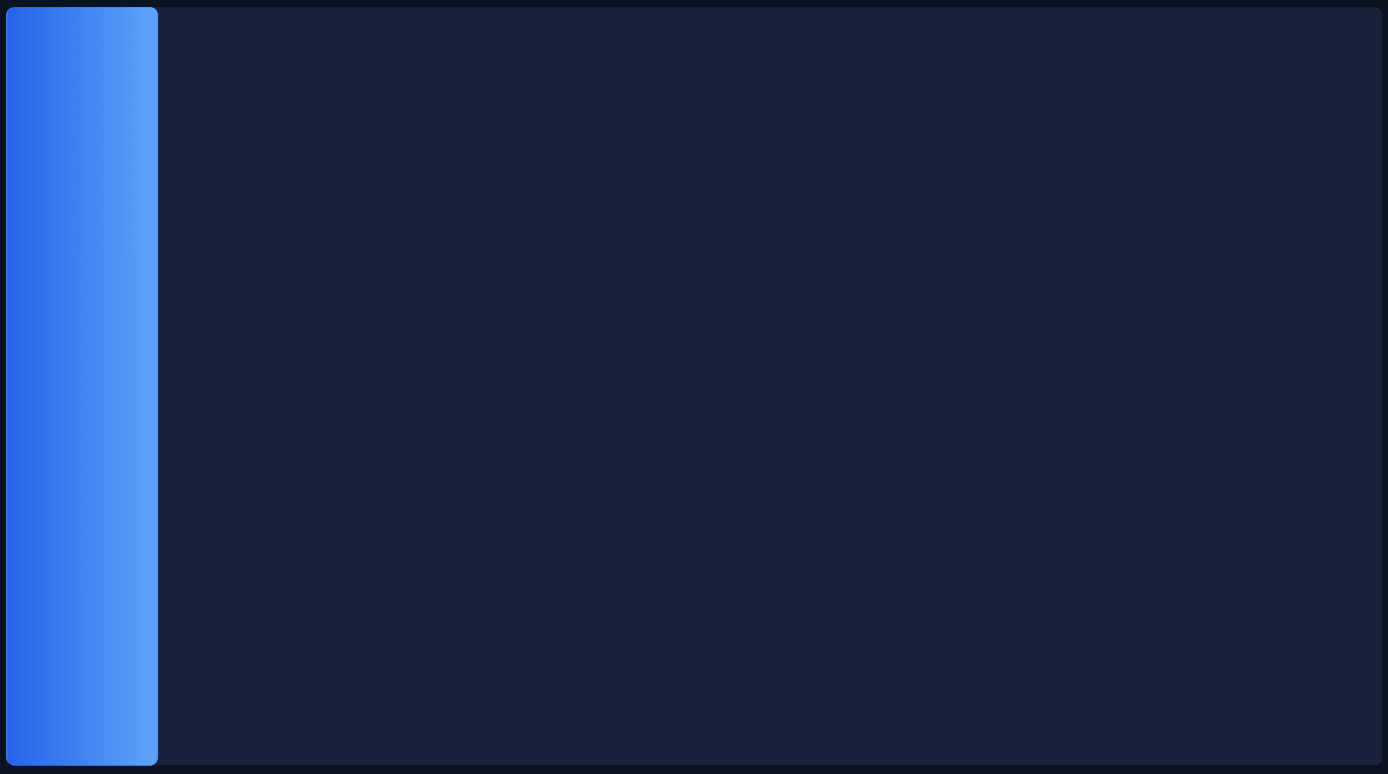
6	708	279	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

28 Fibratus

github.com/rabbitstack/fibratus

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.6k	GITHUB STARS
223	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Security sensor for realtime threat detection and protection"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Windows kernel-event tracing with YARA filtering; a Swiss army knife for endpoint visibility.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by defenders tracing Windows kernel activity for threats; the open-source kernel-observability tool.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



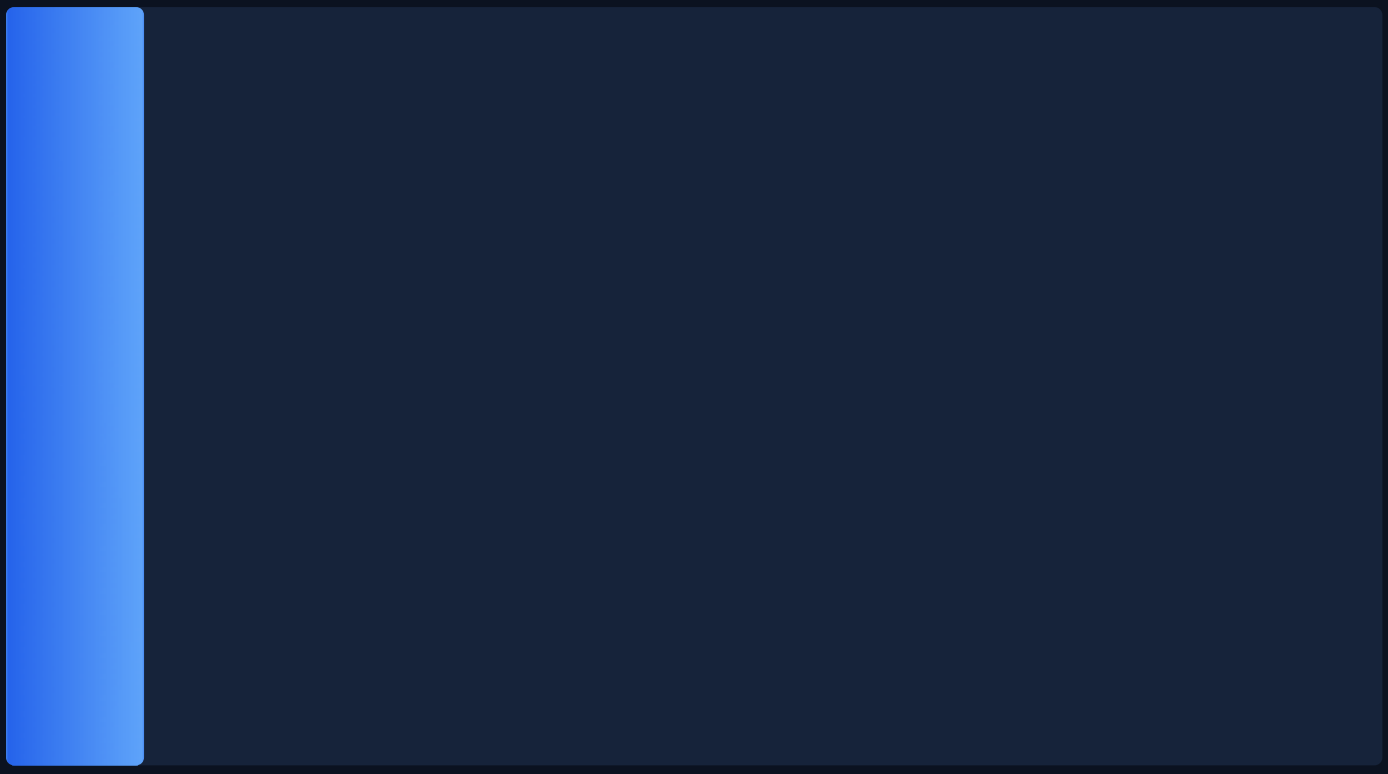
10	223	43	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

29 Shuffle

github.com/Shuffle/Shuffle

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.5k	GITHUB STARS
435	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
AGPL-3.0	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Shuffle: A general purpose security automation platform. Our focus is on collaboration and resource sharing."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

self-hosted SOAR automation: connect your TIP, SIEM and responders in drag-and-drop workflows.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by SOC teams automating playbooks; the open-source SOAR alternative to Splunk SOAR and XSOAR.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

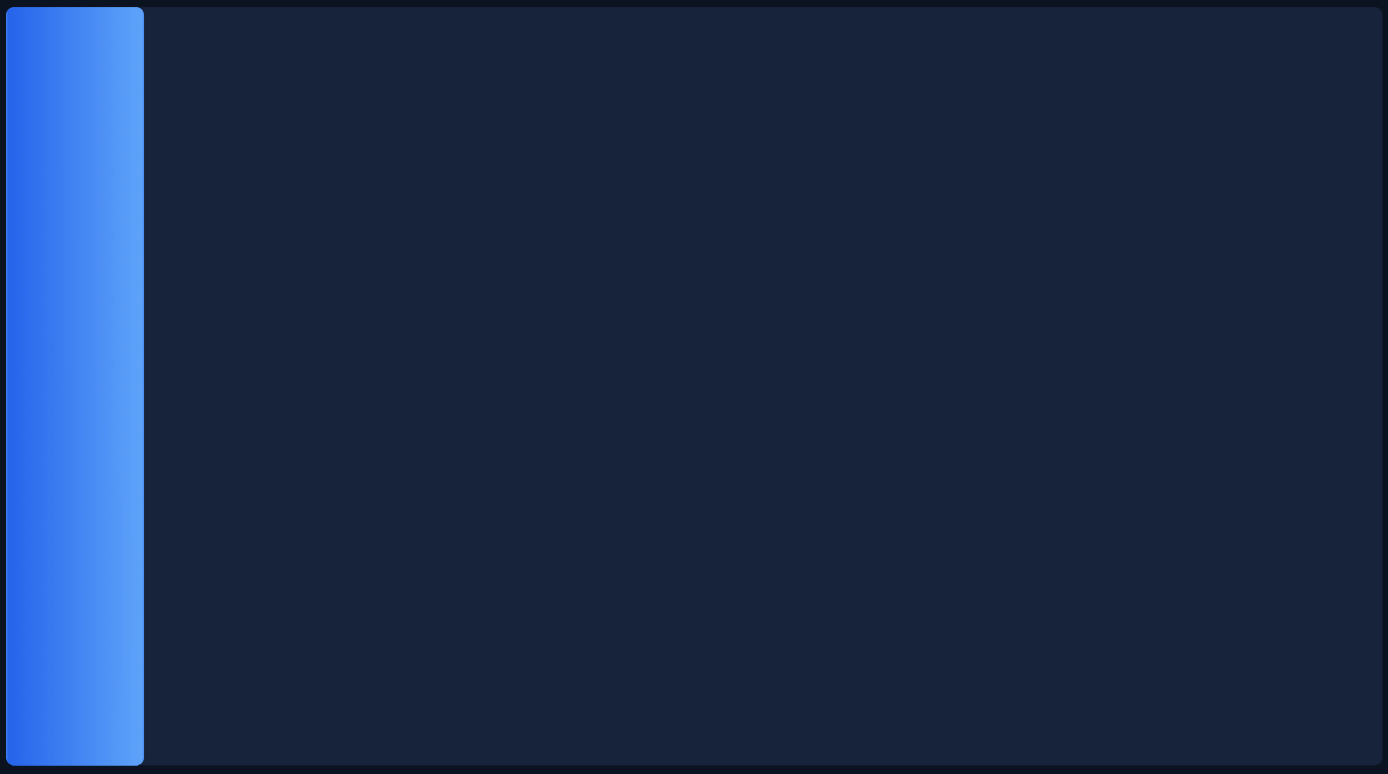


6	435	496	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

30 DeepBlueCLI

github.com/sans-blue-team/DeepBlueCLI

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.4k	GITHUB STARS
377	FORKS
2023-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
PowerShell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"DeepBlueCLI"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

SANS blue-team PowerShell for fast Windows event-log hunting: logons, mutants, suspicious service installs — quiet upstream but still a blue-team staple.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by defenders triaging Windows event logs quickly; the free PowerShell tool for fast log review.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



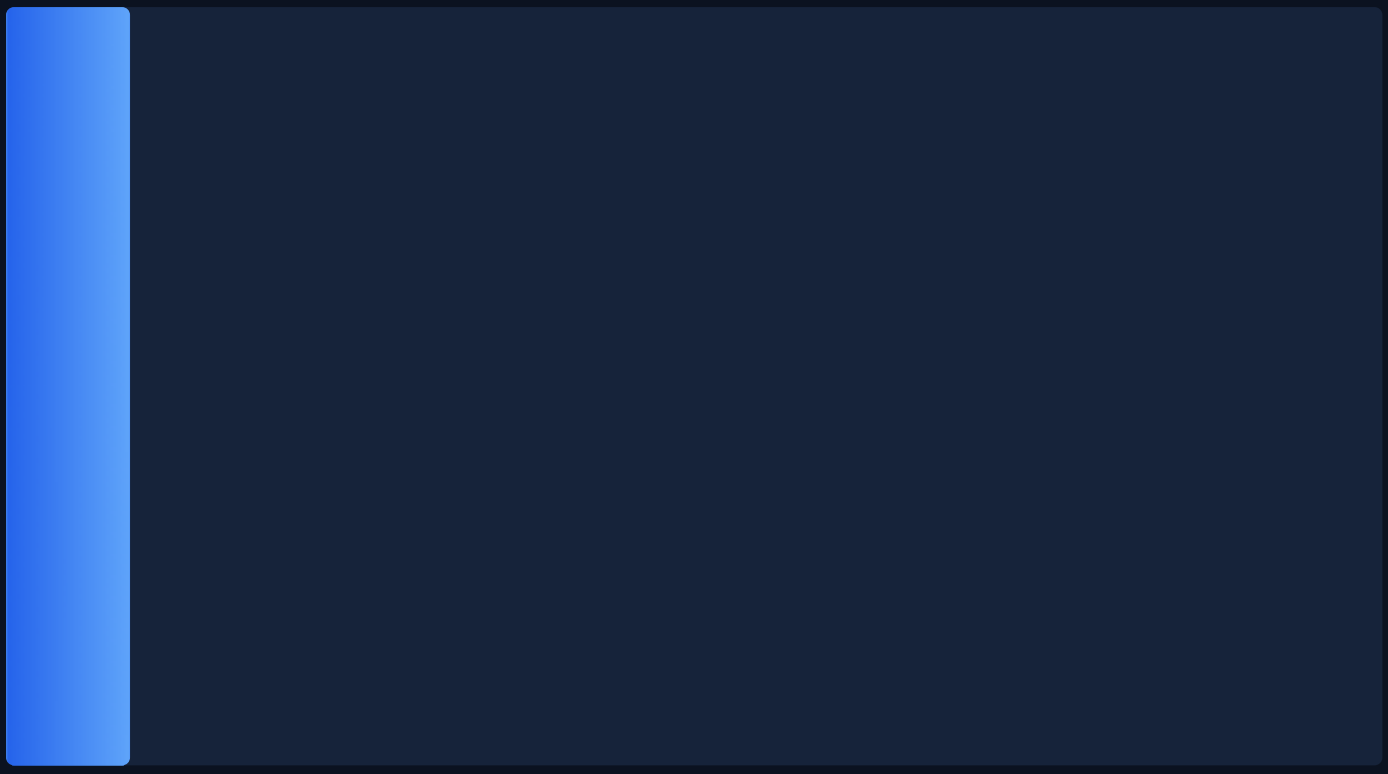
10	377	14	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

31 Kismet

github.com/kismetwireless/kismet

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.2k	GITHUB STARS
390	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
C++	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Github mirror of official Kismet repository"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

passive wireless detection layer: discovers Wi-Fi and BLE devices, rogue access points and wardrives.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by wireless security auditors monitoring WiFi and Bluetooth; the standard open wireless detection platform.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



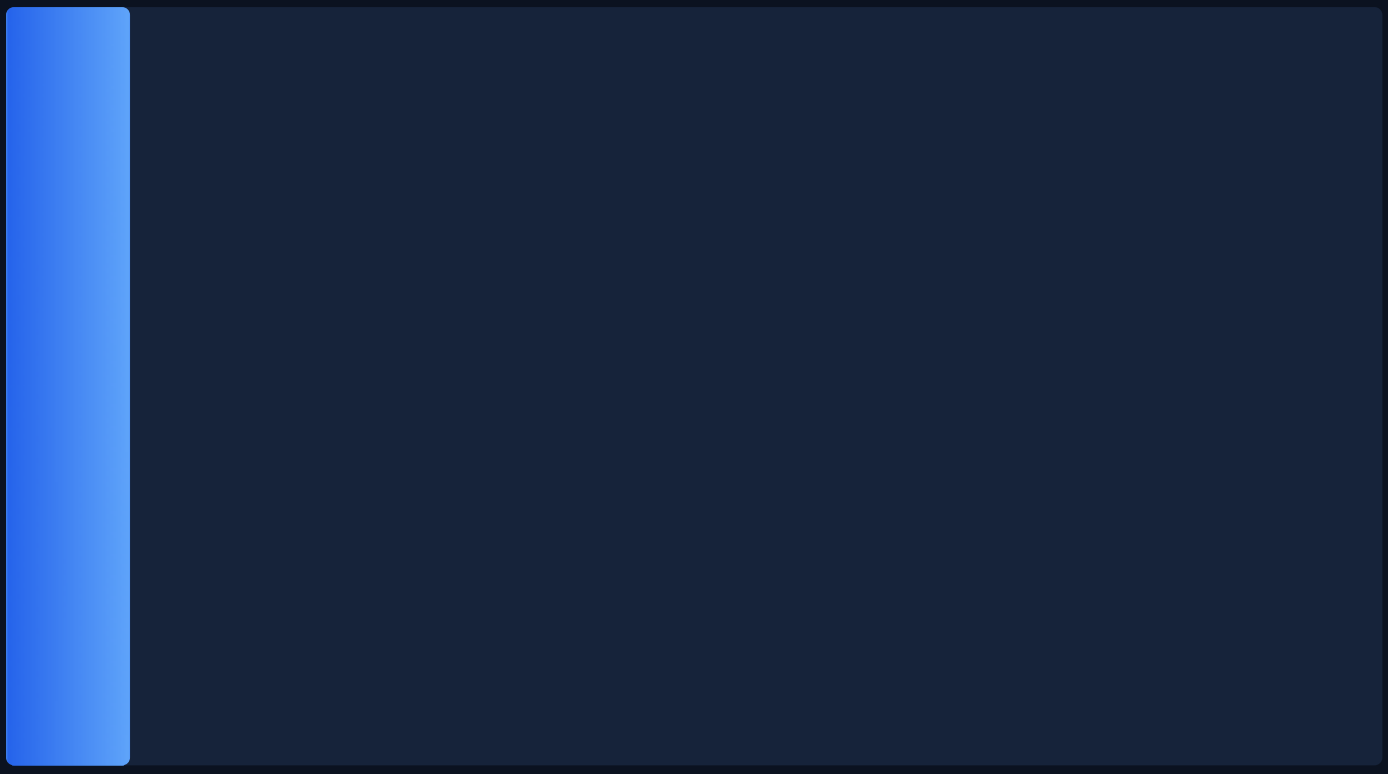
10	390	208	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

32 Sysmon for Linux

github.com/Sysinternals/SysmonForLinux

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.2k	GITHUB STARS
221	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Sysmon for Linux"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Windows-trusted system monitor ported to Linux.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by defenders unifying endpoint telemetry across OSes; Microsoft's cross-platform extension of Sysmon.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



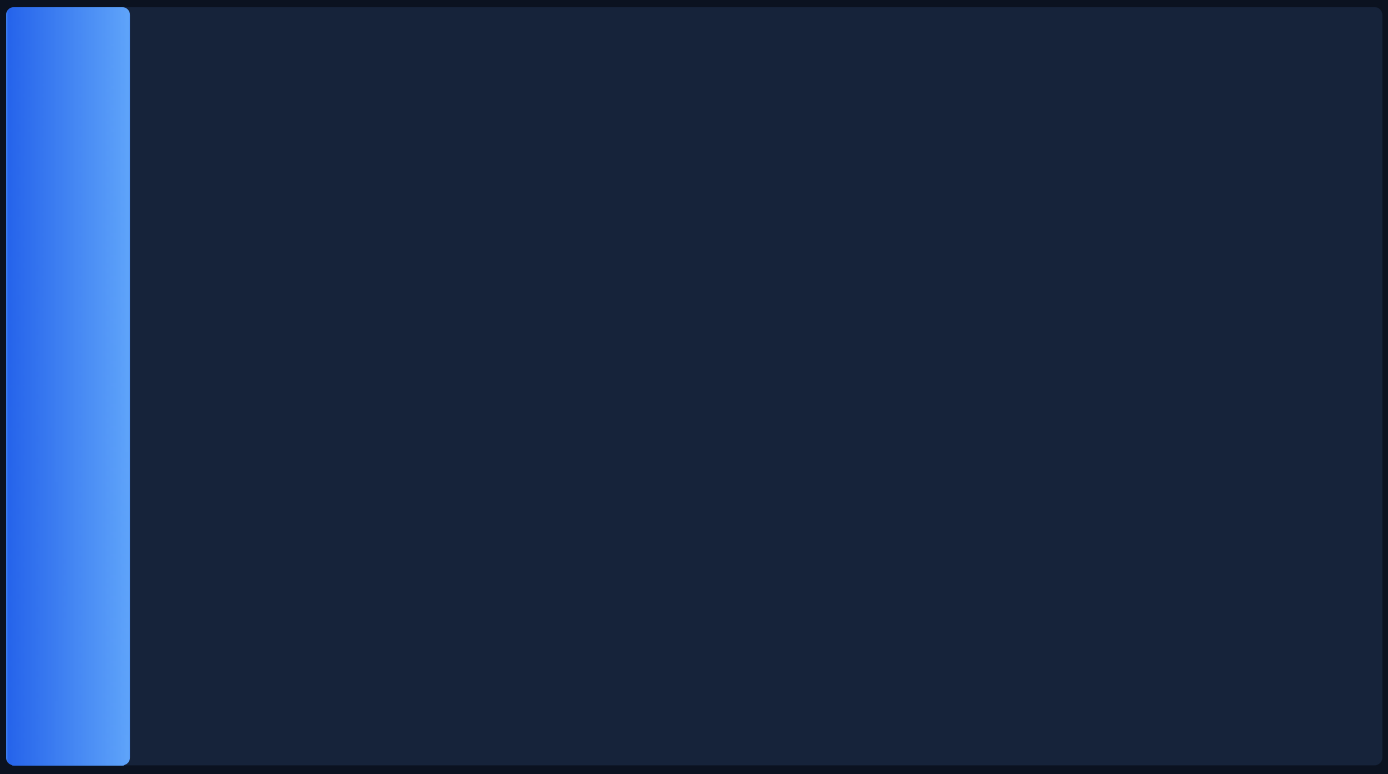
6	221	44	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

33 Nagios Core

github.com/NagiosEnterprises/nagioscore

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.1k	GITHUB STARS
486	FORKS
2026-08	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Nagios Core"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic infrastructure monitor: availability checks that surface outages and anomalies early.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by ops teams monitoring infrastructure for decades; the classic open-source monitoring platform.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



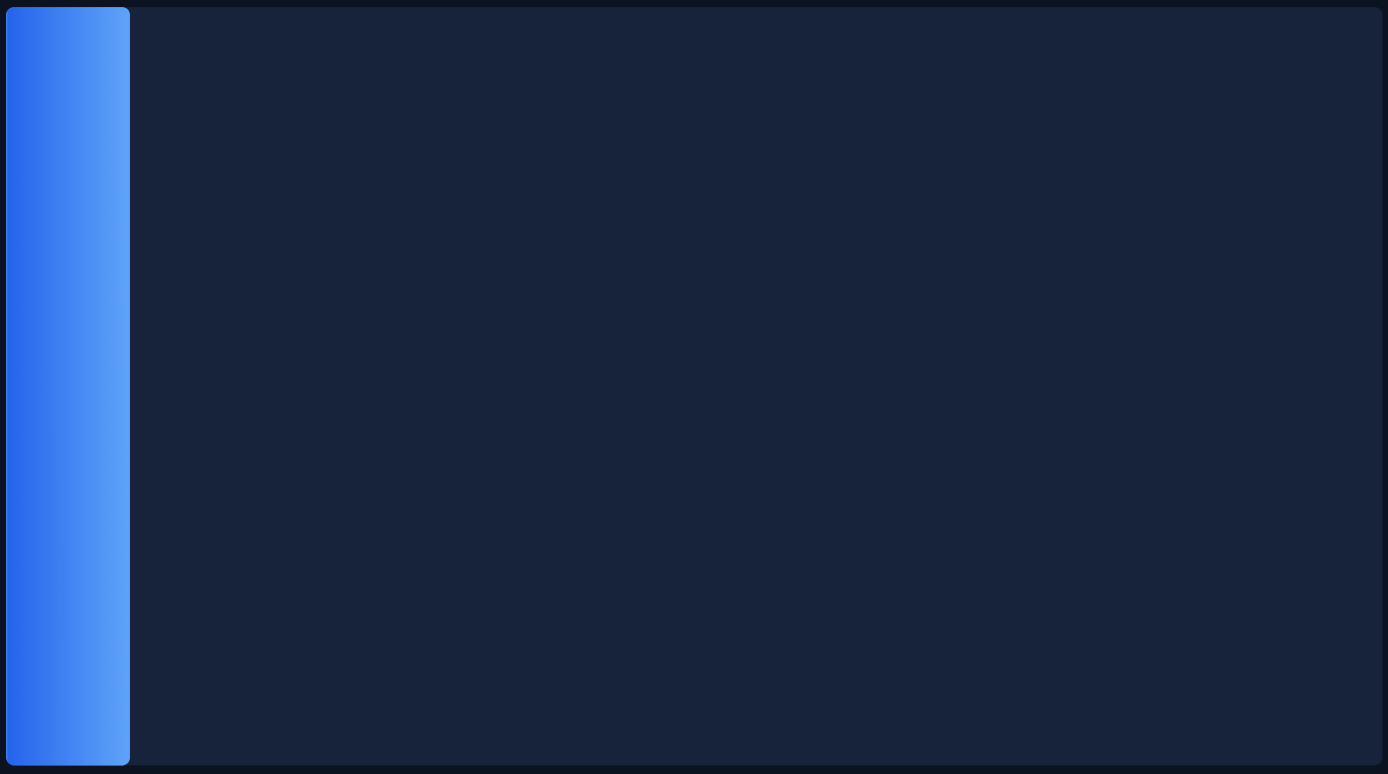
12	486	213	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

34 FIR

github.com/certsocietegenerale/FIR

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2k	GITHUB STARS
511	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Fast Incident Response"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Fast Incident Response from Société Générale: ticketing built for IR workflows.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by incident-response teams managing cases; the open-source IR platform for teams without commercial case tools.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



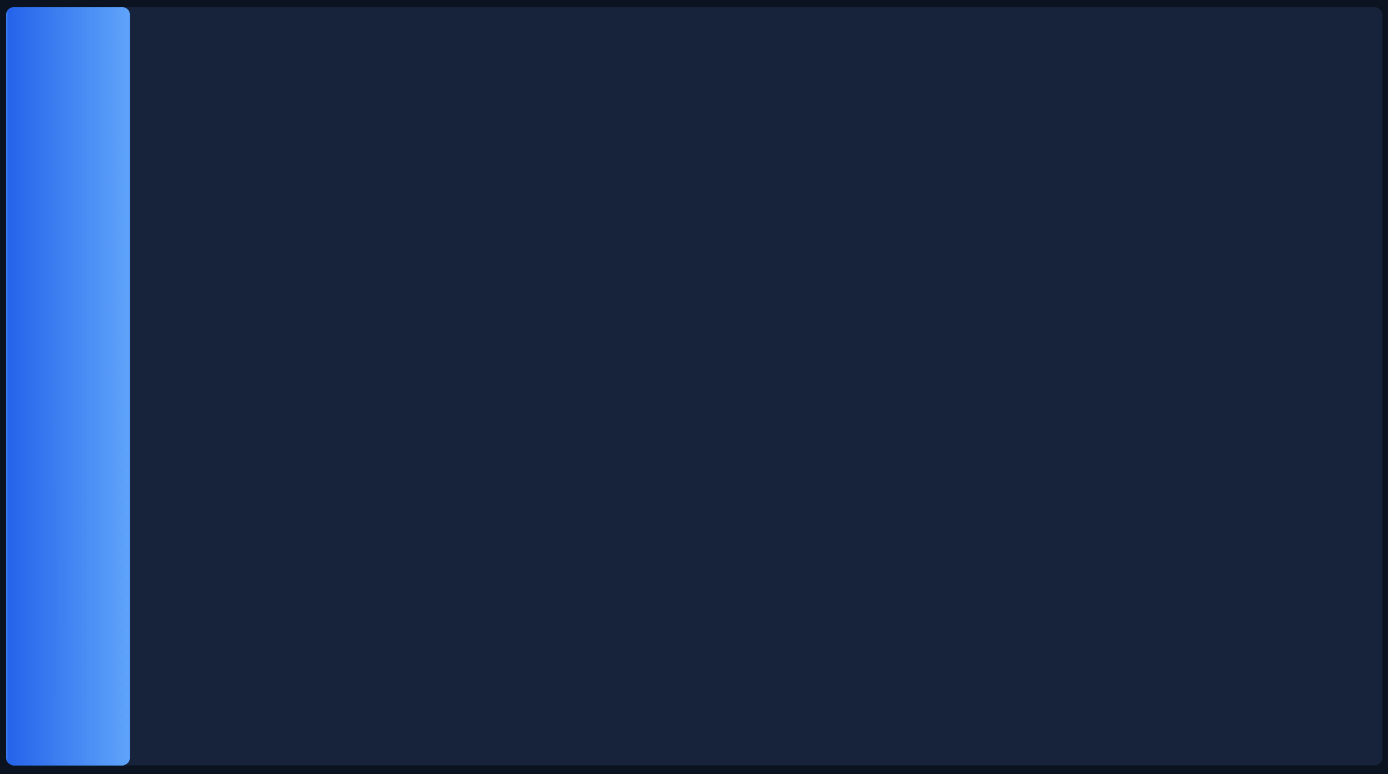
11 YEARS ON GITHUB	511 FORKS (REUSE)	13 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

35 msticpy

github.com/microsoft/msticpy

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2k	GITHUB STARS
344	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Microsoft Threat Intelligence Security Tools"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

SecOps analysis library from Microsoft: pivots, timelines and hunting helpers for Jupyter.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by defenders hunting in Microsoft 365 and Sentinel data; Microsoft's open hunting library.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



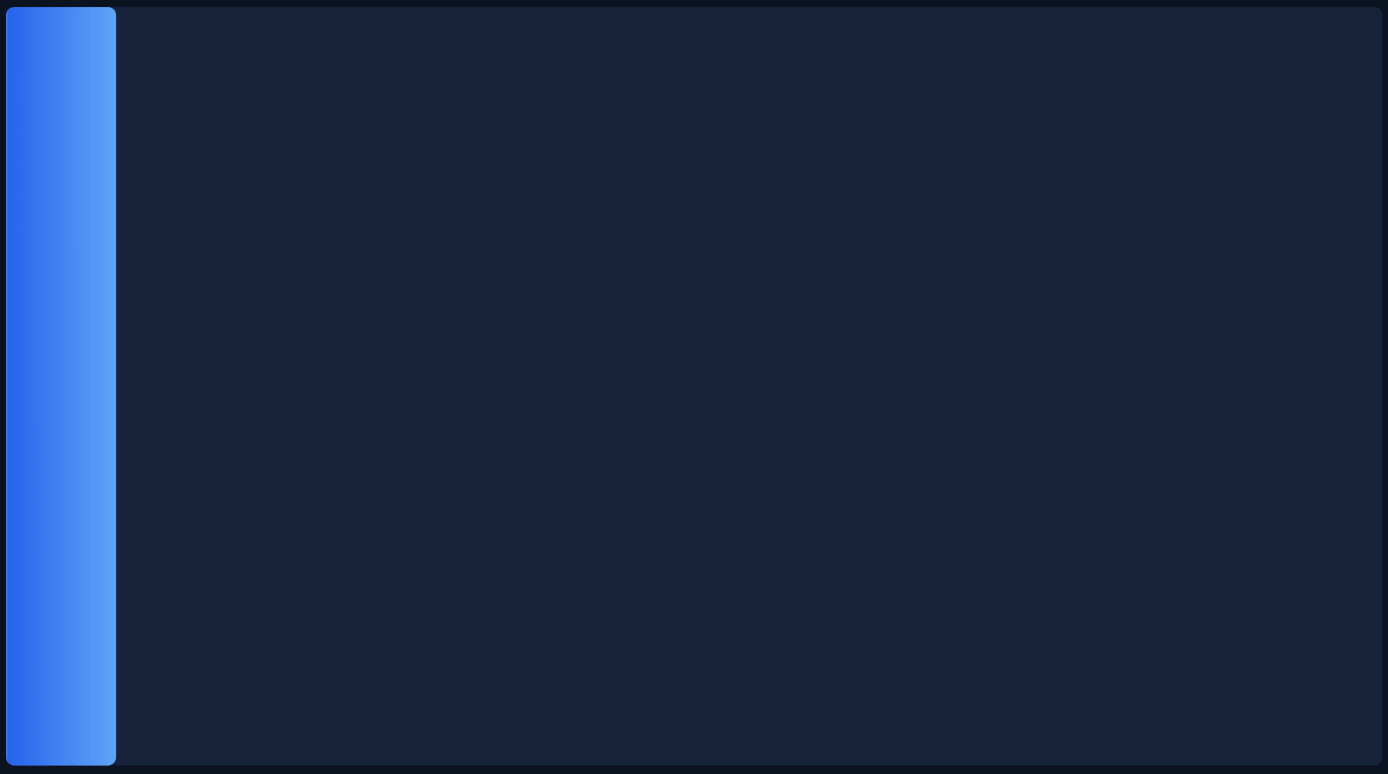
7 YEARS ON GITHUB	344 FORKS (REUSE)	11 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

36 Netcap

github.com/dreadl0ck/netcap

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.8k	GITHUB STARS
171	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A framework for secure and scalable network traffic analysis - https://netcap.io"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

security audit framework over network traffic: sensors, audit and collection from live or captured streams.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by researchers analyzing network captures as structured data; the open-source framework for network-audit work.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



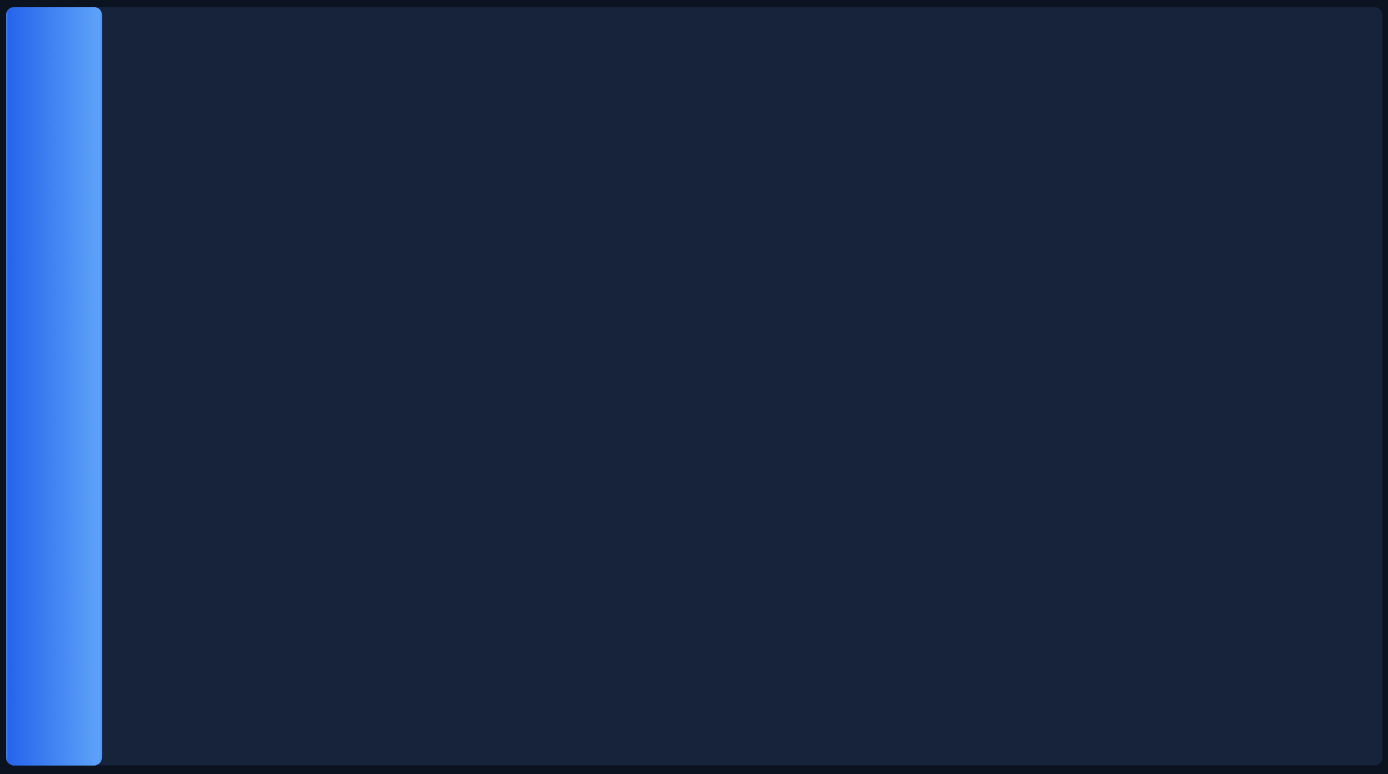
8	171	6	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

37 go-audit

github.com/slackhq/go-audit

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.7k	GITHUB STARS
162	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"go-audit is an alternative to the auditd daemon that ships with many distros"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

auditd in JSON for Linux: structured events that pipelines can actually parse.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by defenders replacing auditd for reliable Linux auditing; the open-source audit daemon for scale.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



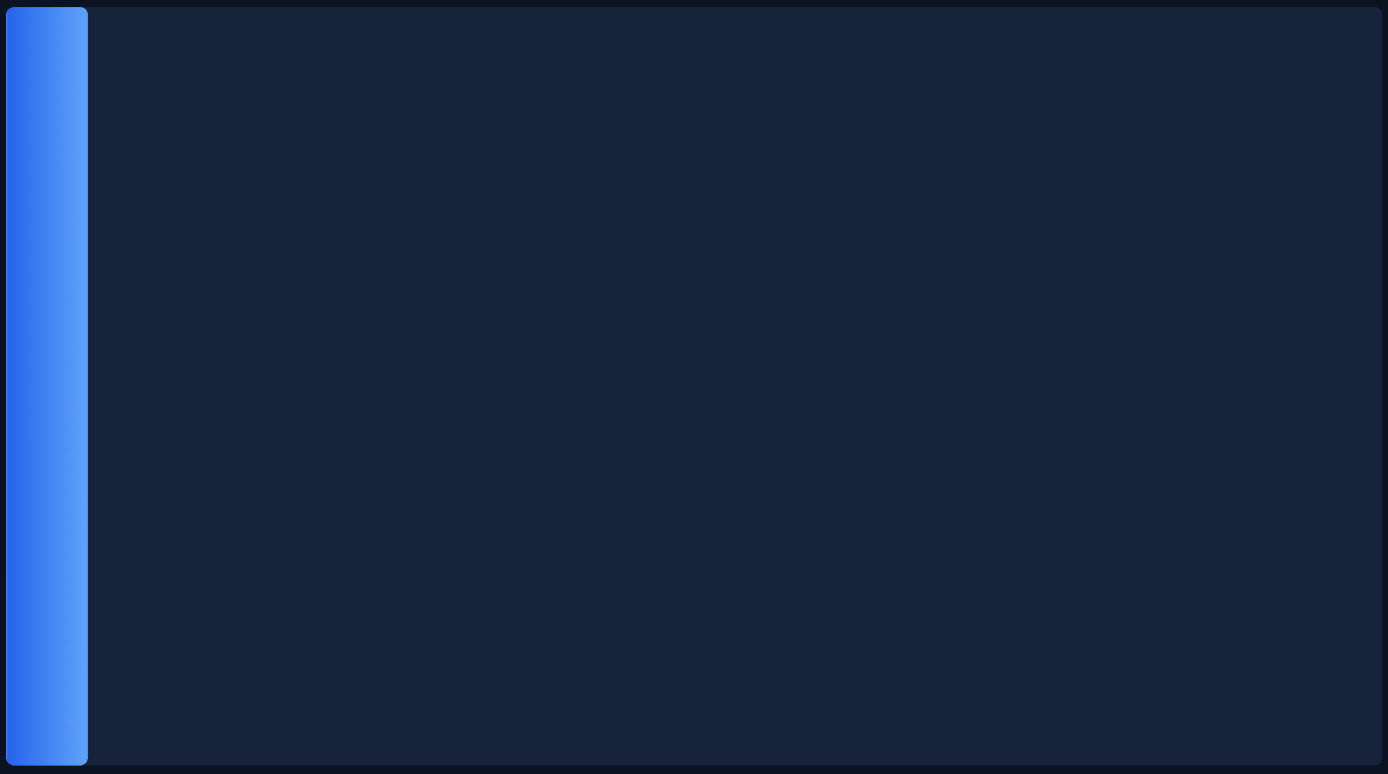
10	162	28	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

38 Conpot

github.com/mushorg/conpot

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.5k	GITHUB STARS
459	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"ICS/SCADA honeypot"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

ICS/SCADA honeypot: emulates the protocols that run factories, safely.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by researchers deploying ICS/SCADA honeypots; the open-source deception tool for industrial protocols.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



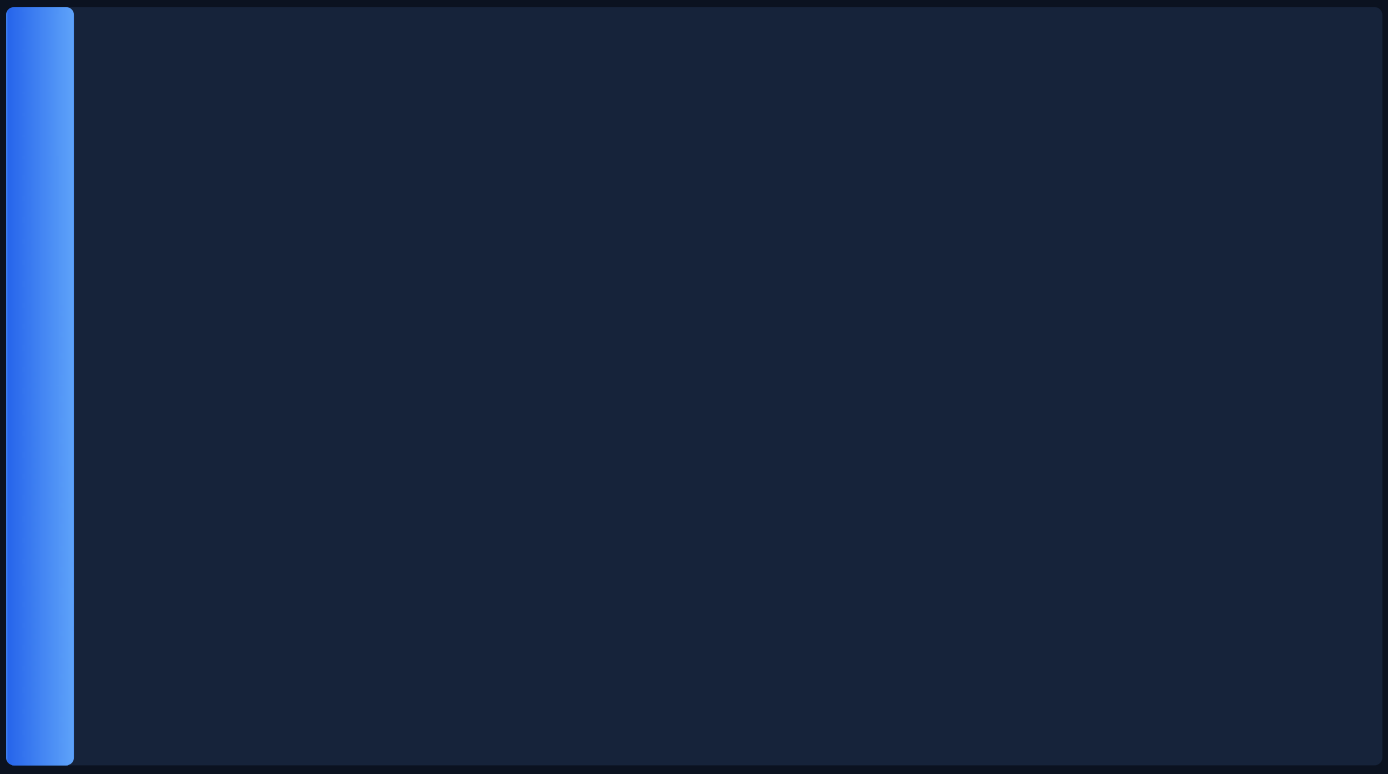
13	459	26	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

39 NoScript

github.com/hackademix/noscript

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.2k	GITHUB STARS
116	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The popular NoScript Security Suite browser extension."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the browser extension that blocks JavaScript and plugin content by default — client-side hardening's origin story.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by privacy-focused users blocking scripts by default; the long-standing open-source browser-hardening extension.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



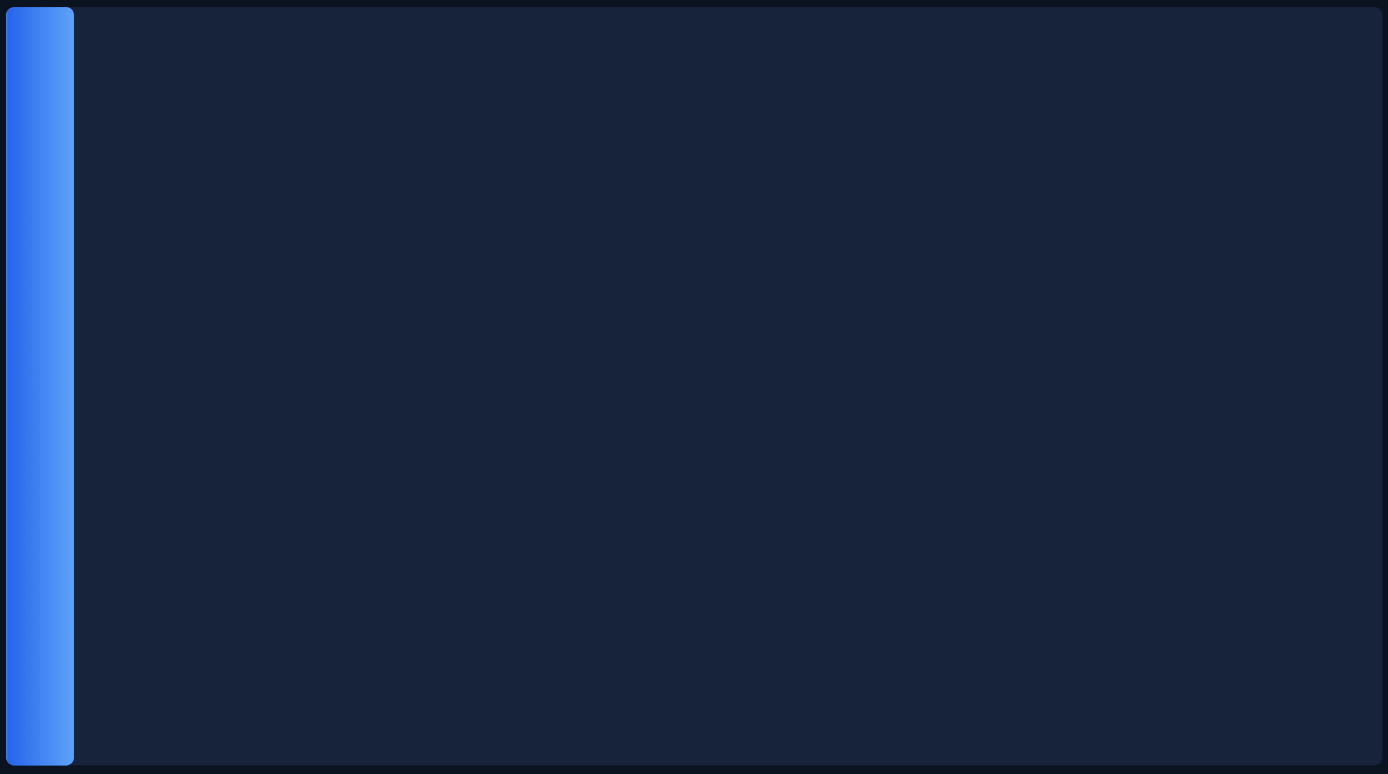
8	116	347	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

40 ElastAlert2

github.com/jertel/elastalert2

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.1k	GITHUB STARS
340	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"ElastAlert 2 is a continuation of the original yelp/elastalert project. Pull requests are appreciated!"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the maintained successor to ElastAlert: flexible alerting on Elasticsearch data with dozens of rule types.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by SOC teams alerting from Elasticsearch data; the open-source alerting layer for ELK stacks.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



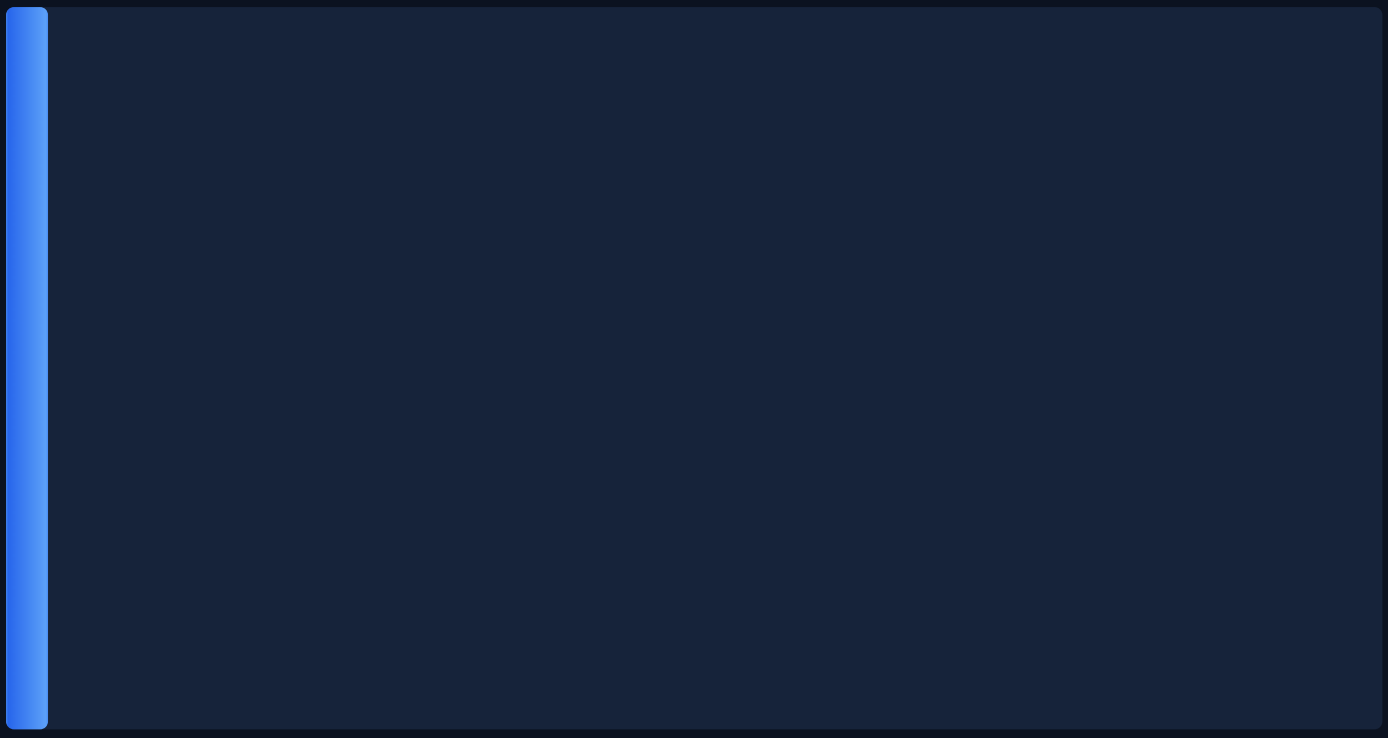
6	340	1	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

41 HijackThis

github.com/dragokas/hijackthis

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 817	GITHUB STARS
129	FORKS
2026-07	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Visual Basic 6.0	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A free utility that finds malware, adware and other security threats"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the veteran Windows hijack analyzer: scans browser and OS settings for malicious tampering.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by technicians diagnosing Windows malware persistence; the veteran free scanner still trusted for autostart analysis.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



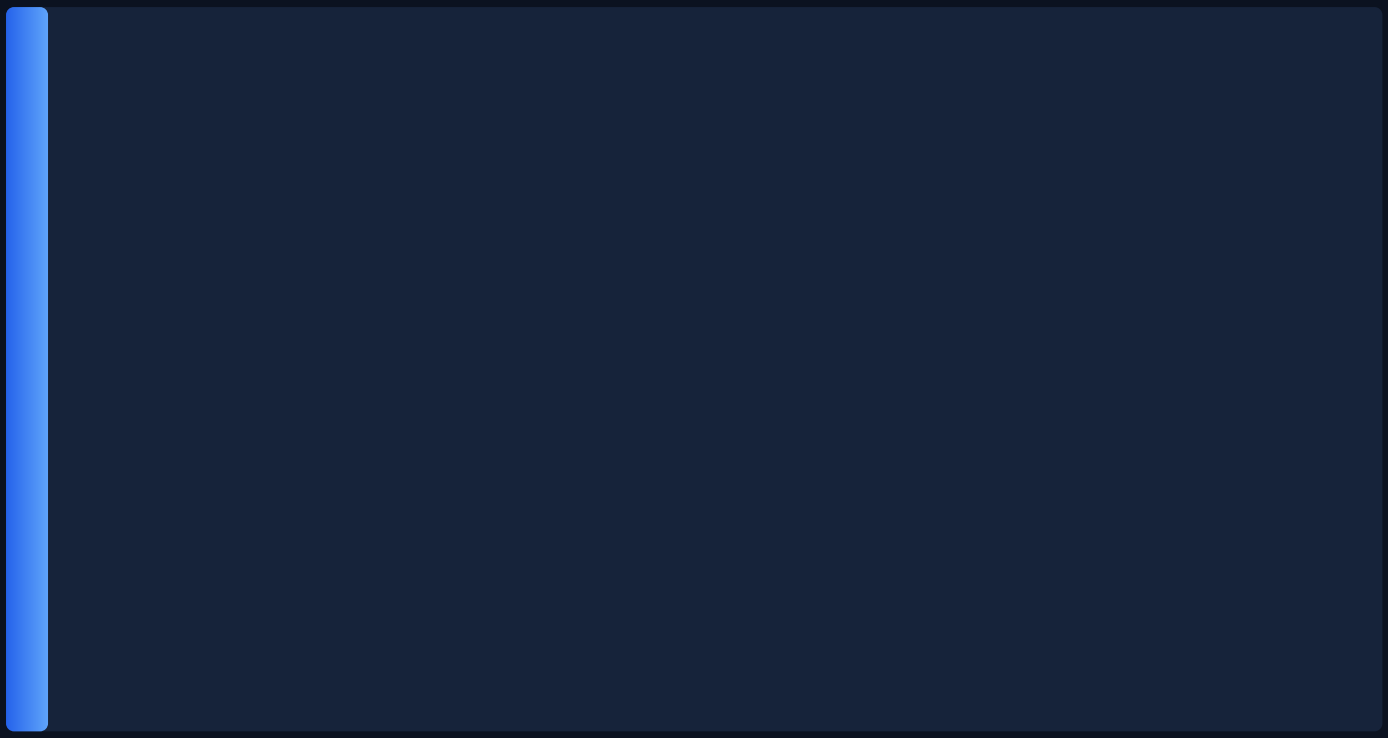
10 YEARS ON GITHUB	129 FORKS (REUSE)	26 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

42 Krawl

github.com/BlessedRebuS/Krawl

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 784	GITHUB STARS
75	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2025	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Krawl is a customizable, lightweight, cloud-native web deception server and anti-crawler that creates fake web applications with low-hanging vulnerabilities using realistic, randomly generated decoy data and AI-generated"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

deception-driven defense: a honeypot server framework for research.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by defenders discovering and inventorying web assets; the open-source exposure-mapping crawler.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

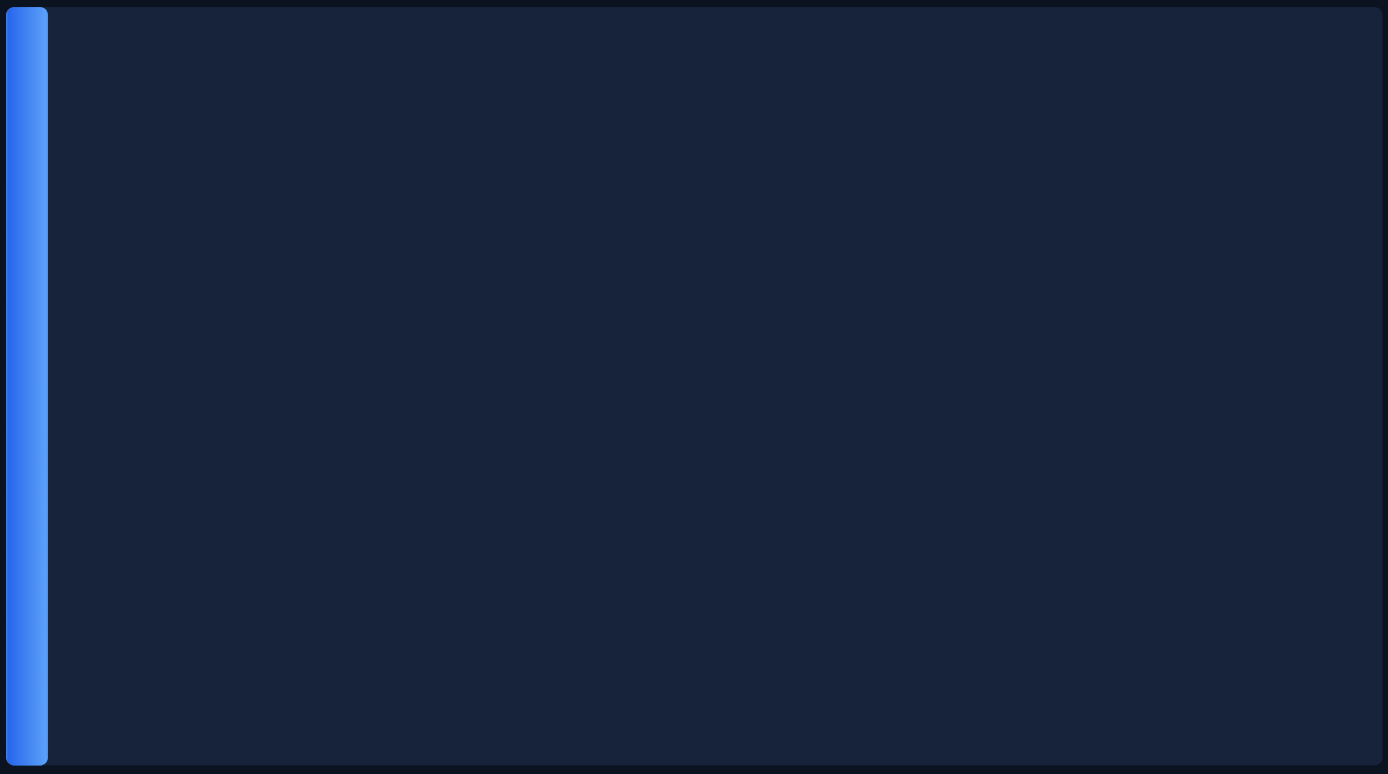


1 YEARS ON GITHUB	75 FORKS (REUSE)	5 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

43 Revoke-Obfuscation

github.com/danielbohannon/Revoke-Obfuscation

star weight vs realm #1



★ 754	GITHUB STARS
123	FORKS
2023-12	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
PowerShell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"PowerShell Obfuscation Detection Framework"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Daniel Bohannon's framework for detecting obfuscated PowerShell at scale; quiet upstream, still the reference.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by DFIR analysts decoding obfuscated PowerShell; the open-source framework for deobfuscation work.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



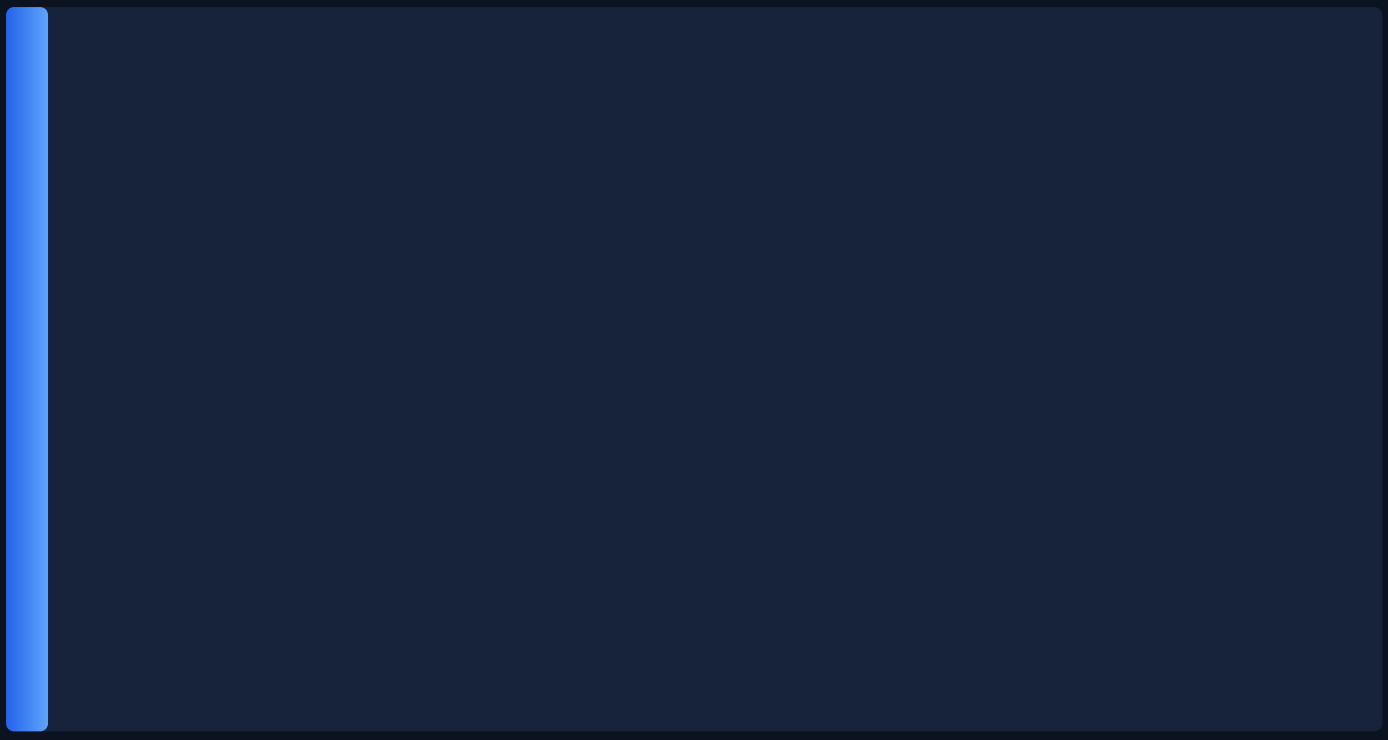
9	123	16	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

44 RITA

github.com/activecm/rita

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 660	GITHUB STARS
71	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2024	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Real Intelligence Threat Analytics (RITA) is a framework for detecting command and control communication through network traffic analysis."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

detects C2 beaconing in Zeek logs — traffic analysis that finds the quiet intruders.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by threat hunters finding C2 beaconing in DNS and flows; the free open-source hunter for network telemetry.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



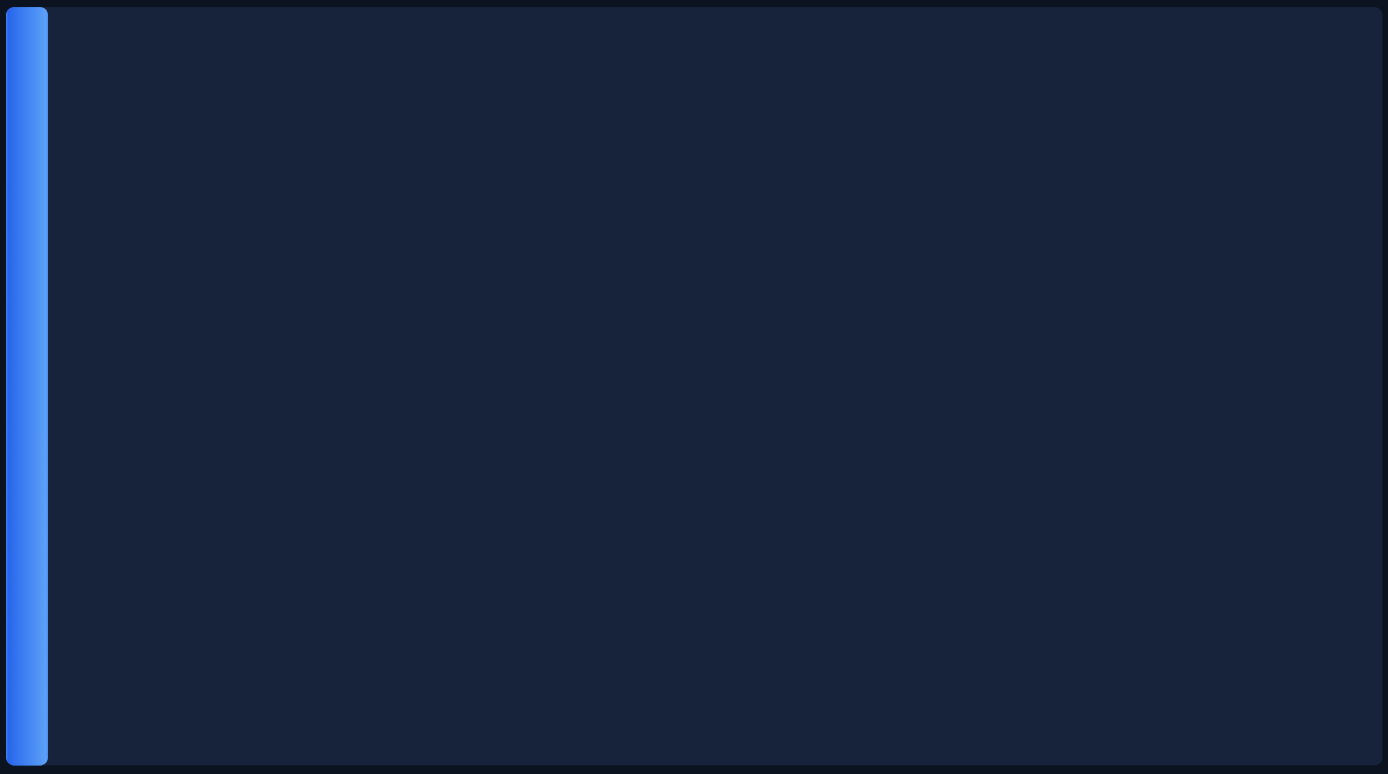
2 YEARS ON GITHUB	71 FORKS (REUSE)	26 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

45 Sublime Rules

github.com/sublime-security/sublime-rules

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 379	GITHUB STARS
99	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
YAML	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Sublime rules for email attack detection, prevention, and threat hunting."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the community rule corpus for the Sublime platform.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by email defenders detecting phishing patterns; the open detection ruleset for the Sublime platform.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



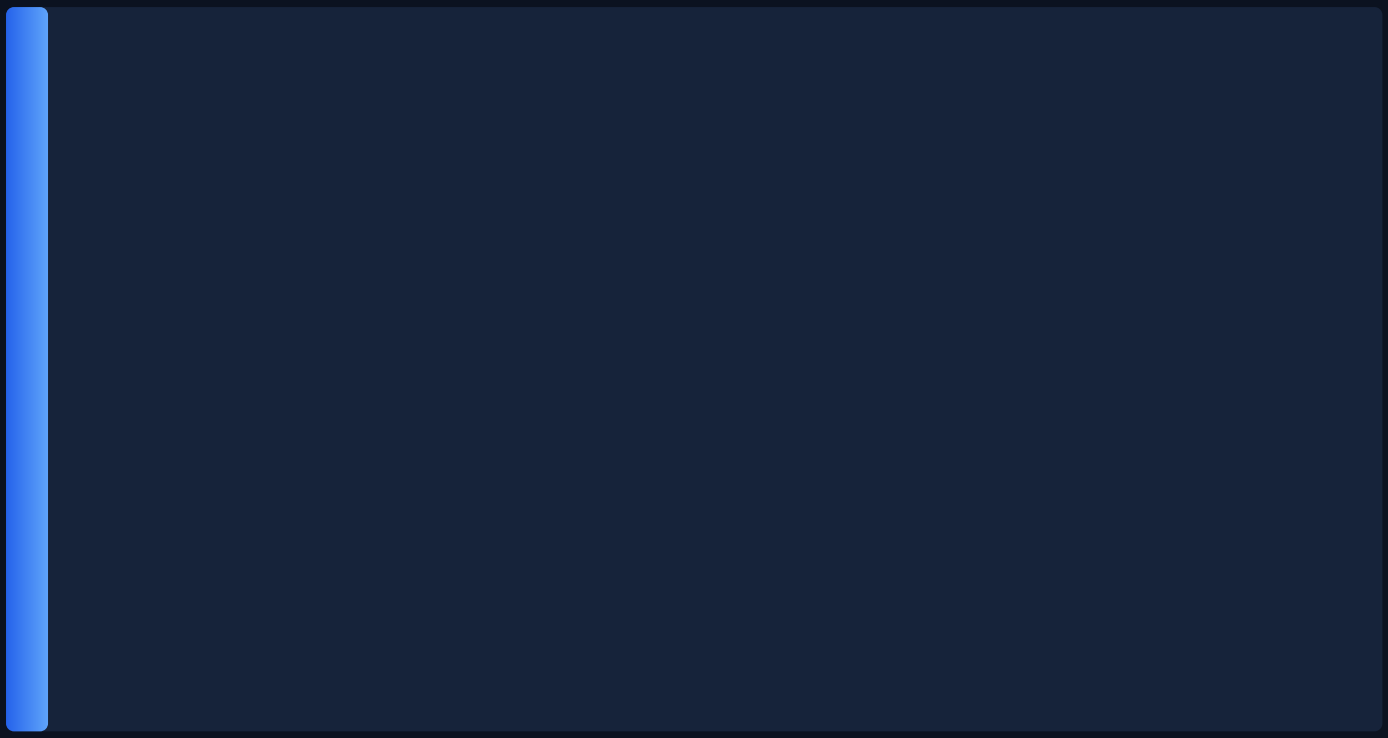
5	99	80	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

46 Sublime Platform

github.com/sublime-security/sublime-platform

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 275	GITHUB STARS
32	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Shell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A free and open platform for detecting and preventing email attacks like BEC, malware, and credential phishing. Gain visibility and control, hunt for advanced threats, collaborate with the community, and write detections"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

open email threat detection: rules-as-code against phishing and BEC.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by email-security teams defending mail flows; the open-source email-defense platform alternative to commercial email gateways.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



5 YEARS ON GITHUB	32 FORKS (REUSE)	13 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

47 Sysinternals Suite

learn.microsoft.com/en-us/sysinternals/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Sysinternals Suite"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Microsoft's free Windows admin and DFIR toolkit: Process Explorer, Autoruns, Procmon and dozens more.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by every Windows admin and IR analyst; Microsoft's free toolkit commercial IR teams also rely on. (free, proprietary)

04 Realm Directory

47 curated entries · A–Z

Arkime
Atomic Red Team
Awesome Incident Response
Awesome YARA
awesome-honeypots
capa
CAPEv2
Conpot
DeepBlueCLI
ElastAlert2
Elastic detection-rules
Fibratus
FIR
go-audit
HELK
HijackThis
Kismet
Krawl
msticpy
Nagios Core
Netcap
NoScript
ntopng
osquery
pspy
Revoke-Obfuscation
RITA
Security Onion
Shuffle
Sigma
Snort 3
Sublime Platform
Sublime Rules
Suricata
Sysinternals Suite
Sysmon for Linux
sysmon-config
sysmon-modular
The Sleuth Kit
Threat Hunter Playbook
ThreatMapper
Timesketch
Velociraptor
Volatility 3
Wazuh
YARA
Zeek